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Delhi to get 'Property Aadhaar Cards'



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Opposition protest student crackdown in Parl



FILM: Pg 12

'Wasn't surprised by Amazon's exit from Artificial'

Parl clears anti-paper leak law amid Opposition walkout

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: Opposition parties led by Congress staged a walkout in the Rajya Sabha on Thursday ahead of the passage of anti-paper leak laws, prompting Leader of the House JP Nadda to condemn the move.

Later in the evening, the Public Examination (Prevention of Unfair Means) Amendment Bill, 2026, was cleared in the Rajya Sabha with a voice vote. The Lok Sabha had passed the Bill on Wednesday.

The Leader of the House, JP Nadda, asserted that the Opposition had no agenda and did not want a discussion, while the government remained ready to debate all subjects. The disruption started after the House assembled following the laying of papers, reports and ministers' statements.

As soon as the day-long debate on the Bill was completed after Kavita Patidar of the BJP finished her speech, Chairman **Continued on P4**

SAYS PAPER LEAK MENACE WILL NOT BE ALLOWED TO CONTINUE
Won't spare paper leak mafia: PM

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Thursday said the government had strengthened the legal framework against examination paper leaks by securing the passage of a tougher anti-paper leak bill in Parliament, describing the issue as a serious threat to the future of students.

In a video message posted on Instagram, Modi said paper leaks had become a major challenge for students as well as for the Centre and several state governments. He said the problem had persisted for years, making it necessary to introduce wide-ranging reforms to improve the examination system.

"The Centre and many states have been facing the paper leak problem for several years," Modi said, adding that the government had been working continuously to build a more reliable and efficient examination process.

Issuing a strong warning to those involved in examination fraud, the prime minister



said, "We will not spare the paper leak gangs, paper leak mafia and those playing with the future of children."

He said the government had already taken several steps to address the issue, including setting up a task force, establishing fast-track courts and seeking suggestions from states to make examinations more secure and prevent irregularities.

Modi said the government remained committed to pro-

viding every student with a fair chance. "Paper leak incidents will not be allowed to continue unchecked. Our campaign against this menace will continue in future too," he said.

Earlier in the day, Parliament passed the Public Examination (Prevention of Unfair Means) Amendment Bill, 2026, which seeks to strengthen the existing anti-paper leak law by introducing tougher penalties for those involved in examination fraud. **Continued on P4**

CLOSER LOOK

» CCS reviewed energy security, supply chains and geopolitical developments

» Government said petrol, diesel, LPG and fertiliser supplies remain adequate

» Fertiliser availability is sufficient for the upcoming Rabi season

» CCS discussed alternate fertiliser sourcing to prevent shortages

» Modi directed a unified government mechanism for continuous crisis monitoring

ALTERNATIVE LPG PROCUREMENT SOURCES HAVE BEEN SECURED AGAINST DISRUPTIONS

PM orders coordinated plan to protect fuel supplies, Indians

SIMONTINI BHATTACHARJEE

NEW DELHI: Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Thursday chaired the fourth special meeting of the Cabinet Committee on Security (CCS) on the West Asia conflict, directing a coordinated government response to protect India's energy security, supply chains, citizens and diaspora as escalating hostilities continue to disrupt key global shipping routes. The high-level meeting reviewed

the country's preparedness to ensure uninterrupted supplies of petroleum products, natural gas and fertilisers, assessed the safety of Indian seafarers in conflict zones, and examined the wider impact of tensions around the Strait of Hormuz, the Red Sea, the Gulf of Aden and the Black Sea. Officials informed the CCS that there is no shortage of fuel or fertilisers and that contingency measures have been put **Continued on P4**

EXCLUDES THOSE WITH CRIMINAL RECORDS

Delhi govt to drop cases against most NEET protesters

CJP demands withdrawal of all FIRs; seeks Amit Shah's resignation over police action

AIMAN FATIMA

NEW DELHI: In a significant relief for students and protesters who participated in demonstrations over the alleged NEET (UG) examination irregularities, the Delhi government on Thursday announced that it will not pursue any adverse legal action against those involved in the protests and will expedite the review and release of those arrested or detained. The decision follows directions issued by the Supreme Court and marks the formal closure of cases arising from the agitation, except for individuals with criminal antecedents.

However, the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) defended the right to protest, demanded withdrawal of FIRs and sought Union Home Minister Amit



KEY POINTS

- » Arrested protesters' cases to be reviewed on priority
- » Detained protesters may be released expeditiously
- » Cases linked to protests to be treated as closed
- » Relief excludes those with criminal antecedents

Shah's resignation over police action on protesting students. **Continued on P4**

Odisha medical PG exam question paper shared on social media during test

BHUBANESWAR/BERHAMPUR: An investigation has been launched after photographs of a question paper from the All Odisha Medical PG Examination were allegedly shared on social media while the test was in progress, officials said on Thursday.

The incident reportedly took place on July 27 during the General Surgery theory paper of the MS/MD course for the 2023-26 batch. Officials said images of the second question paper were circulated in WhatsApp groups created by some postgraduate students. There were also claims that answers were being shared from certain phone numbers while the examination was underway.

The matter surfaced after a postgraduate student of a private medical college in Bhubaneswar reported receiving the images through a WhatsApp group allegedly created by a student of MKCG Medical College and Hospital in Berhampur. **Continued on P4**

Wrong to assume that PM will act against 'democracy': Centre to SC on CEC selection

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Defending the law that governs how the Chief Election Commissioner and Election Commissioners are appointed, the Centre told the Supreme Court on Thursday that it would be wrong to assume the prime minister and other ministers would act in bad faith and against democracy simply because they hold a numerical majority in the selection process.

Appearing for the Centre, Solicitor General Tushar Mehta said the office of the prime minister carries a sanctity that should not be questioned, and that doubting the selection committee's decisions would

weaken the constitutional trust placed in elected institutions. "If his decision is not to be trusted and is to be seen as necessarily a bad-faith exercise, then why not have a provision that even while selecting his Cabinet, he must consult some former judge or outsider?" Mehta asked a bench of Justices Dipankar Datta and Satish Chandra Sharma.

The court was hearing a batch of petitions questioning the constitutional validity of the Chief Election Commissioner and Other Election Commissioners (Appointment, Conditions of Service and Term of Office) Act, 2023. The law leaves the Chief Justice of India out of the panel that selects **Continued on P4**

Pellet guns can't be banned as long as existing advisory permits their use: SC

Asks Centre to preserve ammunition log of RAF used in NEET protests

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: The Supreme Court on Thursday declined to order a blanket ban on the use of pellet guns for crowd control, saying such a direction cannot be issued while existing police guidelines permit their use in exceptional situations. At the same time, the court agreed to examine allegations of misuse during the July 20 students' protest against the alleged NEET paper leak in Delhi, directed the Centre to preserve the ammunition log of the Rapid Action Force (RAF) deployed at Jantar Man-



tar, and asked the Delhi government to provide the best medical treatment to protesters who suffered pellet injuries. The court also issued notices to the Centre and the Inspector General of Police, RAF, on

Justice Bagchi described the petition's request for a complete ban as "vague", saying the existing regulatory framework allowing such weapons had not been challenged

a petition seeking a nationwide ban on metallic pellet ammunition for civilian crowd control.

A bench comprising Chief Justice Surya Kant and Justices Joymaya Bagchi and V Mohana observed that, under

the Bureau of Police Research and Development (BPRD) advisory, police are permitted to use pellet guns in exceptional circumstances.

Justice Bagchi described the petition's request for a complete ban as "vague", saying the existing regulatory framework allowing such weapons had not been challenged.

"If you are interested in phasing out pellet guns, you will have to challenge that very provision as ultra vires to Article 21," Justice Bagchi remarked, referring to the constitutional right to life. **Continued on P4**

MONSOON ENTERS ONE OF ITS MOST ACTIVE PHASES

Monsoon set to intensify in early August, rainfall deficit narrows to 14%

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: India's southwest monsoon is set to remain active through the first half of August, with weather officials expecting rainfall to strengthen further after an uneven start to the season. The improving conditions have raised hopes of reducing the rainfall shortfall and supporting agriculture across several regions.

According to the latest data from the India Meteorological Department (IMD), the country's overall monsoon rainfall deficit has come down to 14 per cent, showing a notable recovery from the larger gaps recorded earlier this season. **Continued on P4**



School students hold umbrellas as they wade through a rain-slicked road

INDIA'S RICHEST 100 FAMILIES TOGETHER OWN RS 76.5 LAKH CRORE

Report: India's top 3,040 wealth creators own Rs 104 lakh crore, nearly 30% of GDP

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: India's wealthiest individuals together control Rs 104 lakh crore, an amount close to 30 per cent of the country's nominal GDP, according to the 360 ONE Wealth Creators List 2026, compiled with Crisil Intelligence. The report studied a wealth base of Rs 330 lakh crore across listed and unlisted holdings and identified 3,040 individuals with a net worth above Rs 425 crore each. Their combined wealth is roughly 1.2 times the size of India's mutual fund industry.

The numbers point to fast wealth creation alongside heavy

TAKEAWAYS

» 360 ONE report identified 3,040 individuals with wealth above Rs 425 crore

» Combined wealth equals 1.2 times India's mutual fund industry

» Top 100 wealth creators hold 46% of total wealth

» Top 10 individuals control Rs 19.72 lakh crore, or 19% of listed wealth

» Bottom 1,520 individuals account for only 9% of total wealth

» Anant, Isha and Akash Ambani top individual rankings with over Rs 2.75 lakh crore each

concentration at the top. The ten richest people on the list hold about Rs 19.72 lakh crore, or 19 per cent of the total. The top 100 individuals account for nearly half the wealth, at 46 per cent, while the

bottom half of the list, made up of 1,520 people, holds just 9 per cent.

Leading the 2026 list are Anant, Isha and Akash Ambani, each worth more than Rs 2.75 lakh crore. Looking at families

rather than individuals, India's top 100 families hold Rs 76.5 lakh crore combined, led by the Adani, Ambani and Mittal families. Twelve business families now have wealth above Rs 1 lakh crore each, including Adani, Ambani, Mittal, Shingvi, Mistry, Nadar, Jindal, Damani, Birla, Agarwal, Premji and Mehta.

The report also points to a generational shift. It lists 285 wealth creators under the age of 40, holding Rs 14.5 lakh crore, about 14 per cent of the total, with average individual wealth of Rs 5,094 crore. This group includes 134 first-generation entrepreneurs, 149 from business families, **Continued on P4**

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA

NEW DELHI: Nearly 20 to 25 per cent names may be deleted from Delhi's existing electoral rolls during the ongoing Special Intensive Revision (SIR), with election officials attributing the estimate to Delhi's highly mobile population, frequent transfers of government employees and people shifting homes without updating their voter registration.

A senior official in the office of Delhi chief electoral officer said the figure is only a broad estimate and the actual number would become clear only when the draft electoral rolls are published on August 17. "Delhi has a very large

CLOSER LOOK

» Election officials attribute likely deletions to high migration, transfers and address changes without voter registration updates

» Officials say the figure is only an estimate; the actual number will be known after the draft rolls on August 17

migratory population. Migrating labourers keep shifting from one address to another -- sometimes in Delhi, sometimes outside. Government

employees are posted here, and then move out. There are also new residential clusters.

"That is why there will be a substantial number of deletions in Delhi. But the exact figure will emerge only after the draft rolls are published," the official told PTI on Thursday.

While the citywide figure remains an estimate, some booth-level officers (BLOs) deployed across Delhi have told PTI that the exercise largely involved tracing voters who no longer live at addresses where they are registered. In many cases, the voters have not necessarily left Delhi but have moved elsewhere in the city without **Continued on P4**

Saffron jerseys for Indian hockey teams draw flak from ex-players & Oppn

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: India's men's and women's hockey teams will step onto the turf in saffron jerseys instead of their long-standing blue kits at next month's FIH World Cup in the Netherlands and Belgium, a switch that has drawn sharp criticism from former players and opposition politicians alike, even as Hockey India insists the move was made for practical reasons.

Announcing the new look on social media, Hockey India said the jersey was designed to "tell a story" and reflect "India's pride", adding that the final design came



after talks with players and support staff. The federation said saffron represents courage, sacrifice and victory, and denied that any outside pressure shaped the choice. According to Hockey India, the switch was driven by visibility concerns on the field. "It was observed that the blue playing uniform tended to blend/merge **Continued on P4**

Quick News

GOVT TO MEET META WITHIN A WEEK OVER PM'S FB POST

NEW DELHI: The government will meet Meta within a week over policy and technical concerns after Prime Minister Narendra Modi's July 23 Facebook post was briefly restricted. IT Secretary S Krishnan said Meta must explain the glitch. MeitY found its initial explanation inadequate despite the company's apology and new safeguards for prominent accounts. **See P6**

SC ALLOWS FRIDAY NAMAZ AT DARGAH BESIDE BHOJSHALA

NEW DELHI: The Supreme Court on Thursday allowed Muslims to offer Friday namaz between 1 pm and 3 pm at the dargah adjoining Dhar's disputed Bhojshala complex. Clarifying its July 14 order, the bench said the site has separate access and allowed both sides to mutually agree on another location if needed. **See P6**

ZERO FIR AGAINST WOMAN OVER REMARKS ON PM

CJP protest: AI use to counter tear gas under police scanner

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Investigation into the July 20 clashes during the “Chalo Sansad” protest organised by the CJP has revealed that some protesters may have used AI tools to learn methods of countering police crowd-control measures, including use of wet jute bags to minimise effects of tear gas, police sources said on Thursday.

According to the source, the ongoing investigation has indicated that some participants may have searched artificial intelligence (AI) platforms for information on mitigating the impact of tear gas, and preparing for confrontations with security personnel.

“The investigation is being carried out through multiple methods. We have reasons to believe that some protesters used AI tools or other generative AI platforms to search for ways to immediately reduce the effects of tear gas, including use of wet jute bags, and to prepare themselves with hard hats, masks and goggles,” the source stated.

He said police are in the process of collecting evidence,



which is a time taking process.

Police are also probing the alleged distribution of hard hats, face masks and protective goggles among protesters before and during the demonstration, with the source claiming these items may have been intended to help participants withstand police action during the violence.

The source said investigation is underway and police teams were collecting digital and other evidence to substantiate the findings.

Police have not disclosed names of any AI platforms allegedly accessed, nor have they said whether any digital devices have been forensically examined to establish such searches.

The July 20 protest witnessed clashes between protesters and security personnel at multiple locations, including Parliament Street, Connaught Place and Jantar Mantar in the New Delhi district after demonstrators allegedly attempted to breach police barricades.

According to the police, several incidents of stone-pelting were reported during the violence, forcing security personnel to resort to repeated use of lathi-charge, tear gas, and even pellet guns to disperse the crowd.

Police alleged that more than 200 police personnel sustained injuries in the clashes, while over 65 protesters were injured. More than 15 vehicles, including police vehicles, were damaged during the violence.

Additionally, a ‘Zero FIR’ has been registered against a young woman at the Expressway police station under the Gautam Buddha Nagar Police Commissionerate for allegedly making objectionable remarks against Prime Minister Narendra Modi during a July 23 protest at Jantar Mantar in New Delhi.

The complaint, filed by Smriti Singh, alleged that Ruchika Singh used objectionable language against the Prime Minister and attempted to disturb public peace. Police registered the FIR under Sections 352, 353(1) and 356(1) of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita and launched an investigation.

Delhi BJP seeks Pb Edu Minister’s resignation

NEW DELHI: The Delhi BJP on Thursday staged a protest near the AAP office at Mandi House, demanding the resignation of Punjab Education Minister Harjot Singh Bains over alleged examination paper leaks in the state.

Led by Delhi BJP president Harsh Malhotra, the protesters, including party MPs, MLAs and office bearers, alleged that papers of six examinations had been leaked under the AAP government, affecting the future of around 30 lakh students.

AAP supremo Arvind Kejriwal has denied any paper leaks in Punjab, saying students at two examination centres had attempted to cheat using digital pens but were caught and the paper was not leaked.

The BJP also criticised AAP’s support for the recent CJP protest.

MP05T



Placards called for an end to ethanol blending, accused the BJP of burdening the public with additional costs...

MCD House disrupted as AAP & Cong protest

ANAMTA FATIMA

NEW DELHI: The Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) General House witnessed repeated disruptions on Thursday as councillors of the Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) and the Congress staged separate protests over civic and administrative issues, forcing interruptions in the proceedings.

The protest was initiated by Leader of the Opposition Ankush Narang and other AAP councillors, who entered the House carrying black placards and raising slogans against the BJP-led civic body. The placards called for an end to ethanol blending, accused the BJP of burdening the public with additional costs and alleged that E20 fuel had damaged vehicles. The councillors also alleged that the Centre’s ethanol-blending policy had adversely affected vehicle owners. Congress councillors also held a demonstration inside the House, raising issues concerning contractual employees and civic workers. Their placards demanded the regularisation of contractual doctors and sanitation workers, alleged discrimination against contractual doctors, and accused the BJP-led MCD of failing to fulfil promises made to Multi-Tasking Staff (MTS) employees even after eight months.

According to the Muni-

pal Corporation, the protests disrupted a scheduled discussion on measures to prevent mosquito-borne diseases, including dengue, malaria and chikungunya, as well as water-borne diseases ahead of the monsoon. Mayor Pravesh Wahi criticised the opposition for stalling deliberations on what he described as critical public health issues. The Mayor said the civic body had planned to review preparedness and preventive measures against seasonal diseases but could not complete the discussion because of the disruptions. He also claimed that sustained

anti-larval drives and public health campaigns had resulted in a decline in dengue cases compared with previous years.

Despite the uproar, the General House approved several civic proposals, including the removal of two defunct garbage transfer stations and an unused public toilet in Janakpuri. The Mayor also said he had directed the MCD Commissioner to take action against illegal raw and cooked meat shops along Kanwar Yatra routes.

The protests continued for a considerable period before the House resumed its business.

Khalid moves HC for bail

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Activist Umar Khalid has approached the Delhi High Court seeking bail in the UAPA case concerning the alleged “larger conspiracy” behind the February 2020 northeast Delhi riots.

His plea challenging a trial court’s July 4 decision is listed before Justices Prathiba M Singh and Vikas Mahajan on Friday. Khalid, arrested in September 2020, was booked under UAPA in the case, which is being investigated by the Delhi Police Special Cell.

The riots left 53 people dead and over 700 injured.

No innocents linked to medical scam: ACB

PRAJYOT DEOGHARE

NEW DELHI: The Anti-Corruption Branch (ACB) of the Government of the National Capital Territory of Delhi has refuted reports that the names of innocent domestic workers or people living on the outskirts of the capital were misused to set up shell companies in the alleged Rs 700-crore medical scam.

The ACB said it had found “no iota of evidence” so far that the identities of any innocent domestic workers or other individuals had been used to establish companies allegedly involved in the case. It also said no such person had approached the agency to report misuse of their name, and the investigation had not



‘If any innocent person’s name has been misused in this case, then that person can come forward and inform the investigating agency..’

uncovered any innocent individual whose identity was used to perpetrate the alleged crime.

The clarification comes as the alleged role of drug dealer Rajeev Rangila in the case has come under greater scrutiny. The ACB has described Rangila as the alleged mastermind behind the Rs 700-crore scam, accusing him of creating fake companies to defraud the Delhi government through the procurement of medicines, surgi-

cal items and other healthcare equipment.

Rangila is currently absconding, while several sacked health department officials have been arrested in connection with the case. A senior ACB official said the agency was monitoring everyone suspected of involvement, including Rangila’s close associates who are also on the run.

The official said there was no evidence at present linking

any innocent domestic worker or other person from the outskirts of Delhi to the alleged scam. “If any innocent person’s name has been misused in this case, then that person can come forward and inform the investigating agency. Till then, everyone whose name has surfaced during the investigation is already under surveillance,” the official said.

The Rs 700-crore medical scam is being investigated by the ACB over alleged rigged tenders, inflated prices and irregularities in the procurement of medicines, surgical items and healthcare equipment.

The agency said the investigation remains ongoing and that further action would be taken based on its findings.



Delhi Minister Ashish Sood with the Indian men’s and women’s table tennis teams during the medal ceremony after both teams won gold at the 22nd Commonwealth Table Tennis Championships 2026 in New Delhi

News at a glance

NDMC SUVIDHA CAMP ON AUG 1

NEW DELHI: The New Delhi Municipal Council (NDMC) will hold its monthly Suvidha Camp on August 1 at the NDCC Convention Centre, Jai Singh Road, from 10.30am to 12.30pm. Residents can seek help with civic services, including electricity, property tax, certificates, sanitation, waterlogging, roads, pensions and community facility bookings. Senior officials will facilitate on-the-spot grievance resolution.

DU PHD POLICY DIVIDES FACULTY

NEW DELHI: Delhi University’s revised Ph.D. admission policy has divided faculty members, with some welcoming its alignment with the NEP 2020 and its focus on standardised, transparent admissions. Others have raised concerns over evaluation criteria, departmental autonomy and research supervision, calling for wider consultations before implementation.

20-year-old caretaker found shot dead, suspect on the run: Police

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: A 20-year-old daytime caretaker was allegedly shot dead inside a residential building in Delhi’s Keshav Puram by the building’s night caretaker on Wednesday, police said.

Police received a PCR call regarding the incident at Keshav Puram police station and reached a building in Shanti Nagar, where they found the woman’s body in a room on the third floor. She was found lying in a pool of blood and had allegedly sustained a gunshot wound to the head.

The deceased, identified as the daughter of Kailash and a resident of Azadpur, worked as the daytime caretaker of the building.

Police said the suspected accused, identified as Saurabh, worked as the building’s night caretaker and was allegedly in a relationship with the victim. He reportedly fled the scene following the incident and is currently being searched for.

During the preliminary investigation, police suspect that a personal dispute may have led to a rift between the two, following which Saurabh allegedly shot the

woman and fled.

A crime team and forensic science laboratory personnel were called to the spot and examined the room and surrounding area to collect evidence.

The body has been sent for a post-mortem examination to establish the sequence of events and confirm the cause of death.

Police have registered a case and launched a search for the accused. Investigators are also examining the alleged relationship between the two and the possible motive. Further evidence and forensic reports are awaited.

School safety workshop prompts ten-year-old to reveal sexual abuse by van driver, attendant

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: A 10-year-old girl in Delhi’s Civil Lines allegedly disclosed that she had been sexually assaulted for several years by the driver and attendant of a private van used to take her to school after a government school workshop on good and bad touch.

Police said a 47-year-old school van driver and his 34-year-old attendant have been arrested following a complaint by the girl’s mother to the Pariwartin Police Mobile Kiosk Team (PPMKT) in Civil Lines.

According to the girl’s statement, the two accused alleg-



edly sexually assaulted her on several occasions while taking her to school. She told her class teacher about the alleged abuse during a child safety awareness programme, following which the teacher informed her parents. The family approached police the next day and lodged a complaint. Police said the accused allegedly took the girl

against both accused under Sections 8 and 10 of the Protection of Children from Sexual Offences (POCSO) Act, pertaining to sexual assault and aggravated sexual assault.

Police said the child’s statement is being recorded in accordance with POCSO procedures. Her medical examination has been conducted and she is undergoing counselling.

Investigators said the allegations require further verification and that the probe is examining the circumstances surrounding the alleged abuse over the past three years. Further evidence is being collected as the investigation continues.

An FIR has been registered

Police arrest rape accused on run for 2 years

NEW DELHI: Delhi Police arrested a man accused of raping a woman at gunpoint, recording the assault and blackmailing her into repeated sexual exploitation after evading arrest for two years. The case was registered in September 2024 at Dwarka North police station. Police said the accused gained the woman’s trust through her husband before assaulting her at his Dwarka residence in July 2023. He allegedly threatened her with a firearm, recorded the act and repeatedly exploited her. A Crime Branch team tracked and arrested him from Nangloi on Wednesday. He has seven criminal cases and was declared a proclaimed offender in Nagpur.

MP05T

Jyoti Nagar: Three held for murder of 17-year-old boy

PRAJYOT DEOGHARE

NEW DELHI: The Delhi Police have arrested three people in connection with the murder of a 17-year-old boy in the Jyoti Nagar area, officials said.

The accused have been identified as Arman, 20, a resident of New Kardampuri; Alfaiz, 19, of Kardampuri; and Aman Khan, 23, also of Kardampuri.

Police said the victim, who lived in the Kardampuri area, was declared brought dead at GTB Hospital on the night of July 28. Police were alerted by the hospital through a PCR call at around 11pm and subsequently began an investigation.

The preliminary probe revealed that the boy had allegedly been stabbed by



the three accused in Gali No. 4 of Kardampuri. A forensic team was constituted to examine the crime scene and collect evidence.

Police said CCTV footage from the area and information gathered through local sources helped investigators identify the suspects. Arman and Alfaiz were subsequently arrested

by the Crime Branch, while Aman Khan, who had initially remained at large, was arrested by the Jyoti Nagar police.

During questioning, Arman and Alfaiz allegedly admitted their involvement and told police that they had an old rivalry with the victim. At Arman’s instance, police recovered the knife allegedly used in the crime, along with bloodstained clothes he was reportedly wearing at the time.

An FIR has been registered at Jyoti Nagar police station under relevant provisions of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita. Police said none of the three accused has any previous criminal record. Further investigation is underway.

GOVT PLANS SWEEPING DIGITAL LAND RECORDS OVERHAUL

Delhi to get ‘Property Aadhaar Cards’

AIMAN FATIMA

NEW DELHI: In a major push to modernise land administration and curb long-standing property disputes, the Delhi government has announced plans to introduce the Delhi Land Records Bill, 2026, under which every property in the national capital will be scientifically surveyed, digitally mapped and assigned a unique ‘Property Aadhaar Card’.

The proposed legislation, which is currently in the approval process after being reviewed by the Group of Ministers, aims to create an authenticated digital identity for every residential, commercial and other category of property across Delhi. The government will also convene a special session of the Delhi Legislative Assembly to table the Bill.

Announcing the initiative on Thursday, Chief Minister Rekha Gupta said the move would transform Delhi’s property management system by making records transparent, organised and technologically secure.

HIGHLIGHTS

- » Chief Minister said the move would transform Delhi’s property management system by making records transparent, organised & technologically secure
- » Just as the Aadhaar card has provided every citizen with a trusted form of identity, every property in Delhi will now be given a secure and authentic digital identity. This will make property records across the Capital more transparent, well-organised and

technologically secure’

» The government will also convene a special session of the Delhi Legislative Assembly to table the Bill



“Just as the Aadhaar card has provided every citizen with a trusted form of identity, every property in Delhi will now be given a secure and authentic digital identity. This will make property records across the

Capital more transparent, well-organised and technologically secure,” Gupta said.

The initiative builds on the government’s implementation of the Centre’s SVAMITVA scheme, under which smart

property cards have already been prepared for 30 of Delhi’s 48 rural villages using drone surveys, GIS mapping and technical support from the Survey of India. According to the government, 12,232 properties have been surveyed so far, of which 8,423 have been identified as dispute-free, while all surveyed properties in the North West and South districts have been resolved. The digital records will eventually be integrated with the Delhi Online Registration Information System (DORIS) for real-time updates.

Expanding the model city-wide, the proposed law will cover not only villages but all urban properties across the National Capital Territory. Every floor of every building will be surveyed and digitally recorded to ensure that no property remains outside the database. The exercise is expected to be particularly significant for Lal Dora villages, where habitation areas have historically lacked authenticated property records, resulting in frequent ownership disputes and legal uncertainties. The government

believes digitised land records will bring greater clarity to ownership in these areas.

Highlighting the need for the reform, the Chief Minister said the absence of a systematic land records mechanism had created problems for decades.

“For decades, the absence of a systematic land records system has caused difficulties in proving ownership, property transactions, inheritance, securing loans, building plan approvals and resolving disputes pending before courts. With the new system in place, authenticated digital property records will be available, eliminating ambiguity, improving transparency and significantly reducing land-related disputes,” she said.

Gupta added that the initiative goes beyond record creation and forms the foundation of Delhi’s future digital governance architecture.

“The records, prepared using modern technology, drone surveys and digital mapping, will help deliver more reliable, secure and efficient services to citizens,” she said.

She further said that the

SVAMITVA property cards are based on advanced digital systems developed with the technical expertise of the Survey of India and drone-based surveys, and “the same technology will now be implemented across Delhi to create a ‘Property Aadhaar Card’ for every property, ushering in a new era of modern land records management in the Capital.”

According to the government, each digital property card will carry a Unique Property ID along with key ownership and land details. A QR code on the card will provide access to authenticated digital records, including property boundaries and related land information, making ownership verification easier and reducing the scope for future disputes.

Once enacted, the Delhi Land Records Bill, 2026 will assign every property in the city a Unique Property ID through its Property Aadhaar Card, creating a unified and authenticated digital land records system while easing property transactions and reducing the burden of land-related litigation.

3,000 schoolgirls to get cycles today

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Chief Minister Rekha Gupta will launch the Delhi government’s ‘Vidya Vahini’ initiative on Friday by distributing bicycles to 3,000 Class IX girl students at a programme at the Sports Complex in East Vinod Nagar. The government plans to distribute a total of 1.40 lakh bicycles to schoolgirls across the capital in phases over the next one month.

According to the Chief Minister’s Office, the initiative aims to make commuting to school easier, improve attendance and promote independence among girl students.

Chief Minister Rekha Gupta said the government was committed to ensuring that no girl is deprived of education due to distance, lack of resources or transport-related challenges.

“Vidya Vahini is not merely a bicycle, but a vehicle for the dreams, confidence and brighter future of



“Vidya Vahini is not merely a bicycle, but a vehicle for the dreams, confidence and brighter future of Delhi’s daughters

Delhi’s daughters. We want every girl in Delhi to reach school safely and without fear, receive quality education, and achieve every goal she sets for herself,” she said.

MCD to launch 5-yr PPP policy to modernise school stadiums

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA

NEW DELHI: The MCD is set to launch a five-year policy to upgrade and operate sports infrastructure at its school stadiums through the public-private partnership (PPP) model, allowing private players to develop and commercially run the facilities while providing free coaching to the civic body’s school students.

According to the policy titled “Policy for Development and Operation of Sports Infrastructure in MCD Stadiums under Control of Education Department in PPP Mode, 2026” and seen by PTL, the civic body aims to modernise under-utilised sports facilities without any capital expenditure from it.

According to the officials, the civic body’s education department currently has 14 stadiums with minimal facilities for sports such as football, cricket, volleyball, badminton, and athletics, where the infrastructure upgrade under the PPP model will be undertaken.

Under the policy, private operators selected through a two-stage bidding process will bear the entire cost of construction, refurbishment, operation and maintenance of the stadiums.

In return, they will be allowed to offer paid coaching and sports facilities to the public outside school hours, the officials said.

The policy says “MCD intends to ensure all stadiums under the education department provide free access to organised sports training for enrolled students while also offering professionally managed coaching programmes for the wider community on commercial terms.”

The officials said the policy permits operators to develop sports infrastructure, such as football turfs, cricket practice facilities, tennis, basketball, volleyball and badminton courts, athletics tracks and sports science centres, besides common amenities including changing rooms, washrooms, cafeterias, first-aid rooms and security systems, subject to approval by the higher authorities.

“To monitor student progress, all enrolled students will undergo baseline fitness assessments before coaching begins. The tests will cover body mass index (BMI), a 30-metre sprint, standing broad jump and a 300-metre run,” the policy states.

Furthermore, the policy states, “Student performance will be tracked through a digital athlete profiling system, with all data remaining the property of the MCD.”

The policy also mandates dedicated initiatives to encourage participation of girls in sports and community outreach programmes such as weekend sports activities and neighbourhood tournaments.



MCD & OIL ink deal for 2 Bio-CBG plants

ANAMTA FATIMA

NEW DELHI: The Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) on Thursday signed a Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) with Oil India Limited (OIL) to establish two Bio-Methanation-based Compressed Bio-Gas (Bio-CBG) plants, marking a significant step towards scientific waste management and the city’s ‘Waste-to-Wealth’ initiative.

The agreement was signed in the presence of Delhi Chief Minister Rekha Gupta and Mayor Pravesh Wahi. MCD Commissioner Sanjeev Khirwar, Oil India Chairman and Managing Director Ranjit Rath, and senior officials from both organisations were also present.

Under the first phase of the project, a 500-tonnes-per-day (TPD) Bio-CBG plant will be developed at Tehkhand on 10 acres of land, while a 300 TPD facility will be set up at Okhla on seven acres. Together, the plants will process 800 TPD of segregated organic waste to

produce compressed bio-gas and organic fertiliser.

According to the MCD, Delhi generates around 13,500 metric tonnes of municipal solid waste every day, of which nearly 7,500 tonnes are currently processed through waste-to-energy facilities and a biogas plant. The new plants are expected to enhance the city’s wet waste processing capacity, reduce the burden on landfill sites, and strengthen source-level waste segregation.

Addressing the event, Chief Minister Rekha Gupta said the project reflected the government’s commitment to sustainable urban development and scientific waste management. She said converting wet waste into clean energy and bio-fertiliser would not only reduce environmental pollution but also support the circular economy.

Mayor Pravesh Wahi said the project would improve resource recovery, generate clean fuel, and contribute to a cleaner and greener Delhi through sustainable waste management practices.

AIMAN FATIMA

NEW DELHI: The Delhi government has issued a show-cause notice to a private school in Vikasपुरi after a surprise inspection allegedly uncovered multiple safety, financial and administrative violations, including the operation of 43 classrooms without fire safety clearance. The school has been given seven days to respond, failing which the government has proposed taking over its management.

Education Minister Ashish Sood directed the Directorate of Education (DoE) to initiate what the government described as the “strongest possible action” against the school’s management. “Our government has absolute zero tolerance for

The school had a Fire No Objection Certificate (NOC) for only 39 rooms but was operating 82 rooms, leaving 43 classrooms without any fire safety clearance

any compromise on the safety of our children. This school was operating dozens of illegal classrooms with zero fire safety clearance, putting thousands of young lives at risk daily. When an institution constructs hazardous structures, loots public funds, underpays its teachers,



Education Minister Ashish Sood

and ignores the law, we will act decisively. We are prepared to completely take over the management to protect our students,” Sood said.

According to the inspection report, the school had a Fire No Objection Certificate (NOC) for only 39 rooms but was operat-

Delhi: Wettest, yet most polluted July in 7 years

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Delhi rounded off July with a month of weather contrasts, recording its most polluted July in seven years despite witnessing the month’s first “good” air quality day in nearly a decade, above-normal monsoon rainfall fuelled by a few intense spells after a prolonged dry phase, and the warmest average day and night temperatures in two years.

The city’s average Air Quality Index (AQI) stood at 119 during the first 30 days of July, making it the highest monthly average for the month since 2019, when it was 134, according to an analysis by the Centre for Research on Energy and

Clean Air (CREA). The average was significantly higher than last July’s monthly average of 78.

Even as the monthly average deteriorated, Delhi recorded its first “good” air quality day in July in nine years, with the AQI dropping to 48. It was the lowest daily minimum AQI recorded in July since 2017, when the index had fallen to 43. At the other end of the spectrum, the AQI climbed to 261 during the month, making it the highest daily maximum AQI recorded in July in five years, since 2021 when it was at 266. During the month, Delhi recorded 15 “moderate”, 12 “satisfactory”, two “poor” and one “good” air quality day, while it did not witness any “very poor” day.

INTEGRATED GROWTH FOR AEROCITY

L-G pushes DDA-GMR coordination for Aerocity

SHIVANGI SHUKLA

NEW DELHI: Delhi Lieutenant Governor Sardar TS Sandhu has emphasised close coordination between the Delhi Development Authority (DDA) and GMR to ensure integrated and future ready development of Aerocity, given its strategic proximity to Dwarka.

During his recent visit to Aerocity, the L-G said integration of Aerocity’s infrastructure with the wider sub city would help both areas develop in a complementary manner. The L-G noted that Dwarka is developing into a major investment and commercial destination and termed it a key growth corridor for Delhi’s future. He also directed that green infrastructure and sustainability principles remain at the core of all future planning for Aerocity, stressing that rapid urban development must not come at the cost of environmental considerations. During the visit, officials



from GMR gave the L-G a detailed presentation on ongoing infrastructure development works in the area. The visit was part of his continuing engagement with key growth nodes of the Capital to review on-ground progress and align private infrastructure development with broader urban planning priorities. Discussions focused on sustainable urban planning and the manner in which upcoming infrastructure works are being designed to support long-term, planned growth. The L-G also

reviewed water conservation and flood management systems, with focus on ensuring resilience against waterlogging and flooding during the monsoon season. He further reviewed traffic management measures around Aerocity and plans for seamless last-mile Metro connectivity, which he noted were essential to easing congestion and improving accessibility. The L-G said sustainability, water security and efficient mobility must remain central to Aerocity’s planning framework.

Meat shops may shut on Kanwar Yatra routes

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA

NEW DELHI: Delhi Mayor Pravesh Wahi has written to the Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) commissioner demanding immediate closure of all meat shops and roadside food stalls serving non-veg items along key pilgrimage routes and near devotee camps during the ongoing Kanwar Yatra and upcoming Mahashivratri. In a formal communication to MCD Commissioner Sanjeev Khirwar, the mayor called for swift action to shut down non-vegetarian food vendors across the capital to prevent hurting religious sentiments.

“As you are aware, the holy month of Sawan and the sacred Kanwar Yatra have commenced. Thousands of Kanwar pilgrims travel through various roads in Delhi. During this period, it has been observed that roadside shops and carts selling raw and cooked meat operate at night, which are completely illegal,” Mayor Wahi wrote in the letter. Emphasising that open consumption of non-vegetarian food on public roads causes distress to devotees, Wahi urged civic officials to act without delay. “Therefore, with immediate effect, all raw and cooked meat shops and roadside carts operating along major roads of Delhi or in vicinity of Kanwar camps during Mahashivratri and the Kanwar Yatra should be closed to ensure smooth passage for the pilgrims,” the mayor said.

Every year during the holy month of Sawan, lakhs of ‘Kanwariyas’ (devotees of Lord Shiva) travel through the capital and adjoining areas carrying holy water from the Ganges to offer at local temples.

IFC defaulters get August 15 deadline

AIMAN FATIMA

NEW DELHI: The Delhi government has begun issuing notices to 1,125 commercial properties with pending Infrastructure Fund Charges (IFC), warning that failure to clear the dues by August 15 could result in the attachment of their properties. The move is part of an ongoing probe into alleged irregularities in the collection of mandatory infrastructure charges.

Speaking to *Millennium Post*, Delhi Jal Board (DJB) Minister Parvesh Verma said the government was still awaiting official records for the past five years but had already identified a large number of defaulters through its own scrutiny.

“We asked for data of five years, which we have not received yet. But as per our data, 1,125 commercial properties have dues of more than Rs 25 lakh each. It also includes some malls and big buildings. Even if we give them the benefit of the revised LPSC, around Rs 10 lakh will be recovered from each property. The total loss is around Rs 1,100 crore,” Verma said. He added that notices had already started being issued to these properties. “If they don’t pay the dues after getting the notice, that property will be attached. The deadline to pay the dues is August 15,” the minister said, adding that in the second phase, notices would be served to properties with outstanding dues between Rs 15 lakh and Rs 20 lakh.

The action follows an investigation launched by the Delhi government into residential, commercial and group housing projects that allegedly secured building plan approvals over the past five years without paying the mandatory Infrastructure Fund Charge. Officials estimate the alleged irregularities may have caused revenue losses running into thousands of crores.

According to Parvesh Verma, preliminary findings

TAKEAWAYS

» Speaking to *Millennium Post*, Delhi Jal Board Minister Parvesh Verma said the government was still awaiting official records for the past five years but had already identified a large number of defaulters through its own scrutiny

» ‘We asked for data of five years, which we have not received yet’



indicate that in several cases, applicants obtained approvals from the Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) using Delhi Jal Board letterheads instead of valid no-objection certificates (NOCs) confirming payment of the mandatory charge. The government has also ordered scrutiny of the role of certain DJB officials and MCD staff in the alleged lapses.

The Infrastructure Fund Charge is collected by the DJB on new constructions and redevelopment projects to finance water supply and sewerage infrastructure. Earlier this year, the government reduced IFC rates by up to 70 per cent across various property categories to ease the financial burden on owners. However, officials said investigations revealed that several properties allegedly obtained approvals without depositing the revised charges as well.

The government has maintained that dues will be recovered from all identified defaulters as the investigation progresses.

From Page 1

Won't spare

The bill was approved by the Rajya Sabha through a voice vote after several Opposition parties from the INDIA bloc staged a walkout. The government said the legislation reflected its commitment to take stronger measures to protect students' interests and preserve the integrity of public examinations.

PM orders

in place to maintain supplies despite the crisis.

According to a statement issued by the Prime Minister's Office, the meeting reviewed the evolving geopolitical situation and the steps taken by various ministries and departments in response to the conflict. It was the fourth special CCS meeting on the issue since the West Asia conflict began earlier this year.

The extended meeting was attended by Defence Minister Rajnath Singh, Home Minister Amit Shah, External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar and Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman, along with Chemicals and Fertilisers Minister JP Nadda, Commerce Minister Piyush Goyal, Shipping Minister Sarbananda Sonowal and Petroleum Minister Hardeep Singh Puri. National Security Adviser Ajit Doval was also present.

Cabinet Secretary TV Somnathan briefed the CCS on the geopolitical situation and outlined measures taken to ensure adequate availability of petroleum products, including LNG and LPG, as well as fertilisers. He informed the meeting that LPG procurement sources have been diversified and that stocks and supplies of major petroleum products remain adequate.

Officials said sufficient crude oil availability has enabled Central Public Sector Enterprise refineries to operate at more than 100 per cent capacity, ensuring continued production of petrol, diesel and other petroleum products. The meeting was also informed that there is adequate availability of fertilisers to meet requirements until the upcoming Rabi season.

The CCS assessed fertiliser requirements for the next Rabi crop and discussed alternative procurement sources. Modi directed that all necessary steps be taken to ensure uninterrupted fertiliser supplies.

The Prime Minister also called for a "whole of government" approach to deal with challenges arising from the crisis and directed that a unified and coordinated mechanism be established to regularly monitor developments and ensure quick implementation of measures to safeguard citizens and national interests.

The situation of Indian seafarers serving on domestic and foreign-flagged vessels operating in conflict zones also came under review. Modi instructed the ministries concerned to establish a mechanism for providing timely information, emergency assistance and counselling to seafarers and their families.

He further directed that every effort be made to safeguard Indian citizens and the Indian diaspora from the impact of the conflict. Government data presented in the Rajya Sabha on Thursday showed that 16 Indian nationals, including 10 seafarers, have been killed and 75 injured in the West Asia conflict. Separately, 12 Indians died in an accidental explosion at a gas facility in Qatar in June.

West Asia is home to more than 10 million Indians, most of them living and working in Saudi Arabia and the United Arab Emirates. Officials said India will continue to prioritise the safety of its nationals and protect their interests.

The meeting also reviewed measures aimed at strengthening long-term energy security. The government highlighted expansion of piped natural gas connections, growth of the National Gas Grid, increased LNG import and regasification capacity, wider City Gas Distribution networks and faster approvals for pipeline and last-mile connectivity under the Pipeline Infrastructure Order, 2026. Modi also called for greater reliance on renewable energy, including solar and other non-fossil fuel sources, to improve energy independence.

India imports more than 88 per cent of its energy requirements, making uninterrupted shipping routes critical. Before the US-Israel conflict with Iran, around 40 per cent of India's energy imports passed through the Strait of Hormuz. The continuing conflict has disrupted these supplies, while the Bab al-Mandab, linking the Red Sea and the Gulf of Aden, has also come under pressure after Yemen's Houthis

militia threatened to target Saudi oil tankers and attacked several ships. Shipping through the passage has fallen to an average of 31 vessels a day over the past three days, down from 43 daily during the first half of July. At the same time, attacks linked to the intensifying Russia-Ukraine war have added pressure on oil shipments through the Black Sea, further complicating global supply chains.

Parl clears anti-paper leak

CP Radhakrishnan called Jitendra Singh, Minister of State in the Ministry of Personnel, Public Grievances and Pensions, to reply to it.

However, Congress MP and Deputy Leader of the Opposition in Rajya Sabha Pramod Tiwari demanded the presence of Home Minister Amit Shah in the House.

"We talked about sticks, we talked about bullets. We had a hope that before the discussion in the House, Home Minister Amit Shah would come, but he is not coming," he said.

However, Radhakrishnan rejected it and asked Singh to proceed with his reply, following which the Congress, along with some Opposition parties, staged a walkout.

The Leader of the House in Rajya Sabha said that with these actions, it is clear that the Opposition has lost the issue.

"Today, the discussion has been going on for about 8 hours. Every member has been given the right to speak. The Opposition has listened to all the issues very carefully. And with that, when the minister stood up to answer, Tiwari started opposing it. This is irresponsible behaviour, which is being carried out. And that is why I said that they have no interest in the discussion," Nadda said.

Delhi govt to drop

Delhi Home Minister Ashish Sood stated that protesters with existing criminal cases against them, as well as those who engaged in violence and vandalism, will not be exempt from the withdrawal of FIRs registered during the recent Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) protest at Jantar Mantar.

In a press release, the Delhi government's Home department clarified that the police would not take any adverse legal action against individuals who participated in the CJP-led protest. "The protection, however, shall not extend to persons having criminal antecedents..." it said, citing a Supreme Court order on July 28.

Sood emphasised that the Government of India has already indicated that no action will be taken against student protesters who were expressing their dissent.

This statement was issued to assure innocent students that they need not be scared and no cases will be registered against them, Sood stated.

The Delhi Police registered 13 FIRs as of 6 pm on July 29 in connection with violence during the 'Chalo Sansad' march by the CJP on July 20. The police said it has also identified over 2,800 people with criminal backgrounds who participated in the protest march.

The government also announced that the process of reviewing arrests and detentions already made in connection with these cases would be undertaken on priority.

"With regard to arrests/detentions, if already made, in these cases, the process for reviewing the arrests and releasing the arrested persons will be undertaken expeditiously," the Home Department said in its order.

It further stated that the Delhi government does not propose to initiate any further adverse action against individuals involved in the protests and that the matter will be treated as closed without any future proceedings on this account.

The latest decision effectively brings legal proceedings linked to the Delhi protests to an end, while paving the way for the release of those currently in custody.

The CJP said that objectionable remarks made during protests should be addressed through defamation proceedings rather than criminal prosecution.

It also demanded Union Home Minister Shah's resignation over the police action during the NEET (UG) agitation. The developments came amid heightened security at Jantar Mantar, where additional police personnel have been deployed and metal barricades welded together after the party warned that it would resume its protest unless all FIRs against demonstrators are formally withdrawn.

CJP spokesperson Saurav Das said that "while individuals should be careful about the language used during protests, offensive remarks alone should not invite criminal prosecution." He argued that those who feel defamed have legal remedies against the individual concerned, but using police action against protesters would discourage democratic expression.

He appealed to young demonstrators to maintain decorum during public protests, saying that respectful language strengthens any movement. At the same time, he criticised the use of criminal proceedings against protesters, describing it as an excessive response that could suppress legitimate dissent.

He also urged the police to "exercise restraint and avoid using legal powers in a manner that could be perceived as politically motivated."

Reacting to the Delhi government's order stating that cases against protesters would not be pursued further and may be treated as closed, Das said the wording fell short of the assurance given after the July 25 understanding at Jantar Mantar. According to him, "the government should formally withdraw the FIRs instead of leaving them pending in a dormant state."

He further alleged that the government was incorrectly citing the Supreme Court's observations to justify retaining the FIRs. Das maintained that nothing in the court's order prevented the government from withdrawing the cases and urged it to fulfil the commitments made to protesters after the agitation ended.

Meanwhile, CJP founder Abhijeet Dipke accused Home Minister Amit Shah of bearing responsibility for the police action during the July 20 'Chalo Sansad' march, claiming pellet guns were used against protesters despite the Centre's assertion in Parliament that no shots were fired. He alleged that several students sustained serious injuries and questioned the government's handling of the demonstrations.

Dipke also claimed he had received indirect pressure to join the BJP and referred to threats allegedly received by his family during the agitation. He criticised remarks made by yoga entrepreneur Ramdev and BJP MP Kangana Ranaut against the student movement, asserting that the campaign was aimed at protecting students' rights and democratic values.

With the CJP warning that it could restart its agitation if FIRs are not withdrawn, security has been tightened at Jantar Mantar. Additional Delhi Police personnel have been deployed and metal barricades at the protest site have been reinforced. The party has also launched the SAAKSHI online evidence platform and announced a nationwide legal aid network, supported by a Rs.1 crore corpus pledged by Rajya Sabha MP Kapil Sibal, to assist protesters facing legal action.

Meanwhile, Noida Police have registered a zero FIR against a 25-year-old woman for allegedly using objectionable language against Prime Minister Narendra Modi during the CJP protest at Jantar Mantar in Delhi.

The action was taken following a complaint by Supreme Court advocate Smriti Singh.

According to police, the accused has been identified as Ruchika Singh, a resident of Lotus Zing society in Sector 150, Noida.

Smriti Singh said that she received several videos purportedly showing the accused using abusive language against the Prime Minister.

SC

The petition was filed by former Central Information Commissioner and retired IPS officer Yashovardhan Azad along with injured protesters Prashant Kumar and Sheikh Irshad Mansoori. They sought a nationwide ban on wholly or partly metallic pellet ammunition fired from pump action or projectile action guns for dispersing civilian assemblies, arguing that such weapons are incompatible with constitutional standards governing the use of force.

Senior advocate Vrinda Grover, appearing for the petitioners, told the court that the present case was confined to the use of metallic pellets. She said pellets had been recovered from the bodies of the injured protesters.

"I am not saying pellet guns should not be in the armoury of the RAF or not. Here it is different. They have used metallic pellets," Grover submitted.

The bench said it was willing to examine whether the use of pellet ammunition in the July 20 incident was permissible under the prescribed "graded approach" for handling law and order situations.

Grover argued that no Delhi Police standing order permitting the use of pellet guns could be found in the public domain and urged the court to direct the Union govern-

ment to place any such order on record.

"There is no standing order of the Delhi Police which permits the use of pellets. That is why my difficulty arises, and I have to rely on BPRD. If there is such a standing order, the Union may place it on record. I am sure the Union and the Delhi Police do not wish to fire pellets on innocent youngsters," she said, adding that she had been unable to locate any such standing order.

Solicitor General Tushar Mehta assured the bench that the government would extend all necessary assistance during the proceedings.

Referring to the court's earlier order of July 28 directing preservation of CCTV footage, drone footage, body camera recordings and wireless logs, Grover pointed out that the order had not specifically mentioned RAF ammunition records. The bench then directed that the ammunition log also be preserved.

Mehta responded, "Whatever is required for investigation will be preserved."

The bench observed that even a peaceful protest could suddenly turn violent because of the entry of anti social elements and that law enforcement agencies may have to take decisions on the spot. It noted that graded responses may sometimes be necessary depending on the situation.

The court also directed the Delhi government to provide the best available treatment to Kumar, Mansoori and other persons who sustained pellet injuries during the protest.

According to the petition, the injured protesters were part of the July 20 "Sansad Chalo" march called by the Cockroach Janata Party (CJP) over the alleged NEET paper leak. It alleged that the RAF, deployed to assist the Delhi Police in crowd management near Connaught Place, first used tear gas and lathi charge before firing pump action guns loaded with metallic pellets.

The petition claimed no prior warning or announcement was issued before force was escalated and alleged that several protesters suffered serious injuries, including eye injuries.

It further argued that pellet guns, though often described as "less lethal", scatter hundreds of projectiles over a wide area, making precise targeting impossible and creating a high risk of severe injuries to the eyes and other vital organs. The plea contended that such weapons fail the constitutional tests of necessity, proportionality and reasonableness applicable to restrictions on the fundamental right to peaceful assembly under Article 19(1) (b). Along with a ban, the petition sought compensation, medical treatment and rehabilitation for all those allegedly injured in the incident.

SC on CEC selection

election commissioners, and the petitioners argue this weakens the independence of the appointment process.

Mehta pressed for the matter to go before a larger bench under Article 145(3) of the Constitution, saying it raised a substantial question of constitutional interpretation. He argued that questioning the adequacy of the selection committee amounted to doubting the wisdom of Parliament, and that only the executive and the legislature are directly accountable to the people. "When the executive wants to participate in the selection of another organ, it becomes a question of independence of another organ. Can it be said to the judiciary then that we will not trust your appointments, because there is no outsider? This is not adversarial. I am just saying this as a student of law," he said.

Justice Datta responded with a pointed remark of his own. "As you said judges select judges, we wonder whether judges select judges nowadays," he said. The bench also brought up Dr B R Ambedkar's warning, made a year and a half before his death, that democracy had failed in India, and asked the Centre for figures on how many state ministers currently face criminal cases.

Justice Datta clarified that the issue was not about distrust in the prime minister personally. "We would trust the prime minister. But this has not happened over the years. I rest at that. Now it's 2:1. Two on the side of the PM and one on the side of the opposition," he said, adding that an election commissioner is meant to be independent and that the committee should at least show fairness, even if fairness is being achieved in practice.

Earlier in the hearing, Attorney General R. Venkataramani submitted that the questions arising from the 2023 Anoop Baranwal judgment were significant enough to need a

larger bench. Lawyers for the petitioners opposed sending the matter for reference. After hearing both sides, the bench reserved its judgment on whether the case should go to a larger five-judge bench, and asked the parties to file written submissions. "We are reserving judgment on the reference. You can provide your written arguments," the bench said.

Under the 2023 Act, the selection committee is made up of the prime minister, a Union minister nominated by the prime minister, and the leader of the opposition, or the leader of the largest opposition party, in the Lok Sabha. The law has been challenged by several petitioners, including Congress leader Jaya Thakur and the Association for Democratic Reforms.

The law was passed by Parliament in December 2023, months after a five-judge Constitution bench ruled in March 2023 that the CEC and election commissioners should be appointed by a committee made up of the prime minister, the leader of the opposition, and the Chief Justice of India.

Odisha medical

Following the incident, Odisha University of Health Sciences Vice Chancellor Manas Ranjan Sahoo held a virtual meeting with principals of medical colleges conducting the examinations and advised stricter security arrangements for the remaining papers.

MKCG dean-cum-principal Harekrushna Dalai said the incident could not be called a paper leak because the question paper was allegedly shared from inside the examination hall after the test had begun. "We are surprised despite routine checking and banning mobile phones," he said, adding that an internal inquiry is examining what device was used and how the images were transmitted.

The PG theory examinations began on July 21, with two papers still scheduled on August 1 and 5. A total of 154 students are appearing for the examination at MKCG Medical College and Hospital.

Monsoon set

Meteorologists have linked the revival to the strongest weather system of this year's monsoon, a deep depression currently moving across Maharashtra. Located within the monsoon trough, the system has pulled large amounts of moisture from both the Arabian Sea and the Bay of Bengal.

Its effect has been boosted by the Somali Jet, a powerful low-level wind stream that carries moisture from the Arabian Sea towards the Indian subcontinent. The combined influence of the deep depression, the active monsoon trough and the strengthened Somali Jet has created favourable conditions for widespread rainfall across central and western India.

Heavy rain has already been recorded in Maharashtra, Madhya Pradesh, Chhattisgarh and neighbouring areas, with the weather system expected to continue moving westward over the next few days.

The IMD's rainfall maps show that Central India and Northwest India are now close to normal seasonal rainfall levels. However, deficits continue in the South Peninsula and East and Northeast India.

Several states, including Maharashtra, Gujarat, Madhya Pradesh, Rajasthan and Chhattisgarh, have reported a significant improvement in rainfall over the past week.

Forecasters expect fresh low-pressure systems to develop over the Bay of Bengal in early August, keeping the monsoon active. If the trend continues, the national rainfall deficit may narrow further, improving reservoir levels, benefiting kharif crops and easing concerns over agricultural productivity. Meteorologists said the coming fortnight will be crucial in determining how much of the rainfall deficit from June and early July can be recovered.

Nearly 25% names

transferring their enrolment. Deployed in New Delhi assembly constituency's Ansari Nagar area, BLO Manish Meena said his polling booth presents this very challenge. The booth covers AIMS residential quarters, servant quarters and seven student hostels, where the electoral rolls change constantly as doctors are transferred or retire, students complete their courses and government accommodation is allotted to new occupants.

Before the SIR began, the Election Commission (EC) carried out a pre-mapping exercise to identify

voters who had shifted from their registered addresses. Meena said his polling station, which earlier had around 1,150 electors, saw around 50 per cent of names removed during that exercise.

"I had around 1,150 to 1,200 voters earlier. Around 500 to 600 have already been deleted because people had shifted long ago," he said.

The polling station now has 570 voters, Meena said, adding that he expects another 300 names to be deleted because the voters could not be found at their registered addresses.

He said he had started contacting voters months before the SIR began. "I started calling people from January. Whoever had a mobile number on the voter ID, I called and asked them to get their registration shifted," he said.

Some updated their voter registration. Many did not. "Now there is no option left for them. The only option is that they will be deleted from here and then they can apply afresh," he said.

According to EC's guidelines, BLOs are required to visit an address at least three times before recording that a voter has shifted or cannot be traced. They are also expected to make local enquiries before uploading such cases.

However, the exercise has left some relocated families uncertain about how they will be covered.

Those who were shifted from the Race Course area near the prime minister's residence to the Savda Ghevra resettlement colony, after their homes were demolished, said they had not received enumeration forms either at their old addresses or at the places where they now live.

Some residents said they approached their BLOs at their old address, who informed them that a special camp will likely be organised after August 8 and they would be issued Form 8 to update their electoral details. Until then, uncertainty prevails in households still awaiting enumeration forms.

BLOs also said the exercise has largely covered voters with identifiable residential addresses, including those inhabiting jhuggi-jhopri clusters, unauthorised slums and resettlement colonies. Reaching street dwellers, who do not have a fixed address, they said, was a challenge.

In an unauthorised colony in Babarpur's Subhash Mohalla, a BLO said his polling station has around 1,350 electors. Around 250 cases have been flagged during the ongoing exercise for verification, and estimated that nearly 200 names could be eventually deleted.

"If a voter is not found, we paste a notice at the house, leave the form if possible and make three visits. We also ask neighbours and elderly people in the locality because they usually know who has moved and who is still living there," he said.

If the voter is still not found, the case is shown to booth-level agents (BLAs) of recognised political parties. "They verify whether the voter has actually shifted. If they confirm it, they sign the form with their party affiliation and phone number. Only then do we upload the case under the shifting category," he said.

He stressed that BLOs only verify and upload cases. "The final decision does not rest with the BLO. It is taken by the Election Commission and the concerned subdivisional magistrate or electoral registration officer," he explained.

The exercise has also brought to light duplicate registrations. The BLO said some voters have two or even three voter cards as they applied afresh without deleting an earlier registration. In some cases, the electoral database showed voters enrolled in another state even though they claimed to have been living in Delhi for years.

In another unauthorised colony in east Delhi's Geeta Colony, BLO Bankey Lal said his polling station has 853 voters. After the pre-mapping exercise, 330 names had been deleted. Verification is often complicated because one house number could have two or three households living in it.

Bankey Lal said many residents had originally migrated from Uttar Pradesh's Bijnor and Farrukhabad districts, while others had come from Bihar and Jharkhand decades ago. Some remained enrolled as voters in their native villages despite living in Delhi for years.

"We explain that a voter should be registered only at one place. If someone has their name in the village, they should not keep another registration in Delhi," he said.

The EC has extended the SIR schedule for Delhi, with house-to-house visits to continue till August 8.

The draft electoral rolls are to be published on August 17. Voters whose names are proposed for deletion will be able to file claims and objections before the voter list is finalised.

The final electoral rolls are to be published on October 7.

Indian hockey

with the blue synthetic playing surface, which is now the standard colour of international hockey pitches," the body said, adding that this affected players' clarity on the pitch. Coaches and players reportedly suggested yellow or saffron as alternatives before saffron was settled on.

The tournament will be held from August 15 to 30.

Former India captain Viren Rasquinha, now CEO of the Olympic Gold Quest foundation, was among the first to object, calling the new uniform "embarrassing" on X. He wrote that blue had always been the identity of the Indian team and that he had worn it with pride for years, questioning what he called the "logic of orange." He said his objection was rooted in "pride, identity & legacy."

Former captain and coach V Baskaran was more pointed, arguing the change strips Indian hockey of its identity and dismissing the federation's technical explanation outright. He asked why, after years of playing on blue turf in blue jerseys, the issue had suddenly surfaced, and demanded that Hockey India's leadership explain the real motive. Baskaran, who led India's gold medal-winning squad at the 1980 Moscow Olympics, also pointed to the sport's overseas following, noting that fans in the United States and Canada who travel with the team were now asking what had happened to the jersey they associated with India.

Ajit Pal, who captained India's 1975 World Cup-winning team, called the decision "strange," saying that blue had been worn since 1928 and that it was the jersey he dreamed of wearing as a child. He said Hockey India owed the public an explanation for the change.

In response, Hockey India said changes in jersey colours were not unprecedented. It noted that India wore yellow jerseys during the 2014 FIH Hockey World Cup and sky blue kits with a different design during the 2018 edition. The federation said the latest change was based on technical feedback as well as the symbolic value of saffron as part of the national flag.

The new kit also carries design elements beyond the colour switch, including Mandala-inspired patterns, navy accents drawn from the Ashoka Chakra, and a chest graphic based on the Sudarshan Chakra, along with tricolour piping on the shoulders and sides. The word "India" appears on the front in Devanagari script. A white version of the kit will also be part of the team's gear. Hockey India noted that kit changes are not new, pointing to a yellow jersey used at the 2014 World Cup and a sky-blue design in 2018.

The row spilled into Parliament, where opposition leaders accused the ruling BJP and the RSS of pushing a saffron agenda. Congress leader Priyanka Gandhi Vadra said the freedom struggle was built on truth and nonviolence, not the RSS, while party colleague Amar Singh warned that the Army's uniform could be targeted next. Fellow Congress leader Tariq Anwar linked the row to what he called the BJP's narrow ideology. TMC's Kirti Azad took a different tack, arguing performance on the field mattered more than jersey colour, while still asking why a "religious colour" was imposed on a kit that had always been blue.

GDP

and two investors, with women making up 51 of them. Founders such as Zepto's Kaivalya Vohra and Aadit Palicha, both under 25, reflect how quickly new fortunes are being built, compared with businesses that once took a generation to grow. New-economy creators have a median age of 48, against 60 for those from older, traditional businesses. Even so, older wealth still dominates overall, with people aged 60 and above holding Rs 53.07 lakh crore, or just over half the list's total wealth.

Women now make up 24 per cent of the list, numbering 738, up from 559 last year, and hold Rs 22.6 lakh crore, about 23 per cent of total wealth. Their average holding stands at Rs 3,184 crore, slightly below the male average of Rs 3,486 crore, though women under 40 have the highest average wealth among all female age groups, at Rs 6,542 crore. The report names Roshni Nadar Malhotra, Rekha Jhunjhunwala, Kiran Mazumdar-Shaw, Savitri Jindal and Manju Gupta among the women driving wealth creation across technology, investing, pharmaceuticals and traditional business.

WITH AGENCY INPUTS

'VANDE MATARAM BILL VIOLATES CONSTITUTION, SECULARISM'

Oppn protests student crackdown, Ram Temple donation 'theft' in Parl complex

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Opposition MPs, including Priyanka Gandhi Vadra, protested in the Parliament House complex on Thursday against alleged police excesses against student protesters and theft of donations at the Ram temple in Ayodhya.

The MPs protested in front of Makar Dwar of Parliament. Slogans such as 'chadhawa chor, gaddi chor', 'grih mantri sadan mein aao' and 'who gave the order' were raised by the lawmakers. The MPs also kept a donation box with them and they were seen putting money inside it to symbolise the alleged theft of donations at the Ram temple. Besides Priyanka Gandhi, Congress general secretary K C Venugopal, SP's Dharmendra Yadav, TMC's Sagarika Ghose, JMM's Mahua Maji, among others, participated in the protest.

In a post on X, Venugopal said, "How long with HM Amit Shah hide and not answer the people of India? Why is he MIA (missing in action) from Parliament?"

"We opposition MPs are protesting outside Makar Dwar, demanding a clear answer for who ordered the use of pellet guns against students, and for heckling LOP Shri Rahul Gandhi and preventing him from speaking in the Lok Sabha yesterday," Venugopal said.

The protesting MPs lined up behind a big banner that read 'who gave the order', an apparent reference to the directions to security personnel to use lethal force against student protesters at the recent agitation against NEET paper leak.

Meanwhile, leaders from opposition parties also criticised the Vande Mataram Bill passed by the Lok Sabha, alleging that it violated the secular character of the Constitution, infringed upon religious freedom and sought to impose the full version of the national song despite the Constituent Assembly having accepted only its first two stanzas.

DMK MP Kanimozhi stated that her party opposed the legislation, calling it an attempt to create polarisation.

"The Vande Mataram Bill is against the secularism of our nation. Our founding fathers were very clear that only the first two stanzas should be sung. Now, the government is insisting all the stanzas should be sung. It will hurt the sentiments of people of different faiths," she told reporters.

TMC leader Saugata Roy described the legislation as unnecessary. "This Bill was not needed. We have no objection to Vande Mataram being sung, but Rabindranath Tagore did not want the full Vande Mataram to be the national song. These people have gone even further than Tagore," he said.



Opposition MPs during the protest on Thursday

Highlights

- » The MPs protested in front of Makar Dwar of Parliament. Slogans such as 'chadhawa chor, gaddi chor', 'grih mantri sadan mein aao' and 'who gave the order' were raised by the lawmakers
- » The MPs also kept a donation box with them and they were seen putting money inside it to symbolise the alleged theft of donations at the Ram temple

Anti-paper leak Bill shows zero-tolerance policy: Jitendra in RS

NEW DELHI: The amendment to the anti-paper leak law is a testimony that the government has zero tolerance towards exam paper leaks and its resolve that nobody will be allowed to jeopardise the future of our children, Union minister Jitendra Singh said as the Rajya Sabha took up the Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Amendment Bill, 2026, on Thursday.

Piloting the Bill, Singh said the government has brought this amendment in right earnest and was open to constructive suggestions from all quarters.

The Lok Sabha passed the bill on Wednesday, and now its various provisions will be discussed and debated in the

Says the government has brought this amendment in right earnest

Upper House.

Singh said the bill testifies that this government does not stand on prestige and is open to healthy inputs. "We are open to constructive suggestions from all quarters, and that's exactly the reason why, in the wake of the recent sequence of events, the PM lost no time to declare that nobody will be allowed to jeopardise the future of our children, and also announced the resolve of zero tolerance to paper leak," Singh said.

Meanwhile, as many as 3.61 lakh candidates have been recommended by the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) for government jobs in the last four years, Singh said.

Vacancies in the Union government have been filled up in mission-mode and several lakh appointment letters have been distributed to recommended/selected candidates in National Rozgar Mela events being held regularly since October 2022, he said. "During the last four years, i.e. 2022-23 to 2025-26, the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) has recommended about 3.61 lakh candidates based on the vacancy requisitions submitted by various ministries/departments to SSC," said Singh.

Paper leak Bill a bid to appease youth: Kharge

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge on Thursday said the Public Examinations Amendment Bill remained incomplete for lacking robust provisions to prevent paper leaks, demanding a legally mandated annual examination calendar, a Supreme Court-monitored probe into police action against protesting students, and time-bound filling of government vacancies.

Participating in the debate on the Bill in the Rajya Sabha, Kharge said the government had failed to incorporate Opposition's suggestions made in 2024, forcing it to amend the law within two years of enactment, and that the proposed changes still lacked a strong mechanism to curb paper leaks.

Kharge added that unless



Mallikarjun Kharge speaks in the House on Thursday

institutions and the examination system are reformed and accountability is fixed, paper leaks will continue to occur, and "we will be discussing the same thing here again". "Paper leaks hurt innocent students and their parents," Kharge said.

Congratulating the youth for forcing the government to remove Dharmendra Pradhan as Education Minister, he said that because of their strong voice,

and the Home Minister from the House, saying neither had spoken despite the unrest.

"I felt ashamed. I don't know if he felt ashamed. Who is responsible for the atrocities against students?" he asked. "People's power will drag him out." He asked who authorised the action and who the plainclothes personnel involved were, adding that if Home Minister Amit Shah could not answer, he should resign, failing which Prime Minister Narendra Modi should remove him.

On examination reforms, Kharge said over 152 paper leak incidents had occurred in the past decade without major accused being punished, citing the 2024 and 2026 NEET cases. He also cited parliamentary data showing over three million vacant government posts nationally.

33 projects okayed under Urban Challenge Fund, LS told

NEW DELHI: The government has so far approved or accorded in-principle approval to 33 projects under the Urban Challenge Fund (UCF), Union minister Manohar Lal informed the Lok Sabha on Thursday.

In a written reply to a question, the Housing and Urban Affairs minister said the Urban Challenge Fund was operationalised with the launch of its guidelines on April 15.

The UCF envisages a total central assistance of Rs 1 lakh crore over the mission period to support transformative urban infrastructure projects across the country.

"So far, 33 projects have been approved/ accorded in-principle approval," he said.

According to the minister, the MoHUA has approved or accorded in-principle approval to four projects in Andhra Pradesh, six in Gujarat, three in Karnataka, six in Madhya Pradesh, three in Maharashtra, seven in Odisha, three in Telangana and one in Meghalaya.

He said that the Centre's assistance under the scheme is capped at 25 per cent of the cost of bankable projects.

At least 50 per cent of the project cost has to be mobilised through market-based sources such as municipal bonds, bank loans and public-private partnerships (PPPs), while the remaining cost is to be borne by the concerned state government, Union Territory or urban local body.

Kejriwal slams PM over student FIRs

OUR CORRESPONDENT

CHANDIGARH: Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) National Convener Arvind Kejriwal strongly condemned the police action against students for allegedly mocking the Prime Minister on social media, saying it reflected the misplaced priorities of the BJP-led Central Government.

He said that while China is building an Artificial Sun, India's Prime Minister is busy getting FIRs (First Information Report) filed against young students, buying MPs and MLAs, toppling governments, and manipulating the electoral process through voter deletions and fake voter registrations. Arvind Kejriwal said India now needs a Prime Minister with vision and the ability to think big.

Sharing a video on social media platform X, AAP Arvind Kejriwal said that according to a media report, China is building an artificial sun based on nuclear fusion technology that will generate clean energy similar to the Sun. The project is expected to be completed by 2030. "On one hand, China is building an artificial sun, while on the other, our Prime Minister is busy getting FIRs filed against young children who merely mocked him on social media," he added.

He further said, "While China is building an artificial sun, our government is unable to build proper roads and bridges. A single spell of rain throws our cities into chaos, and garbage is strewn everywhere."

Arvind Kejriwal said the country's governance has suffered because the Prime Minister is preoccupied with buying MPs and MLAs, toppling governments, deleting people's votes, and getting fake votes added. "These days, the Prime Minister is even busy getting FIRs filed against young children who made fun of him on social media."

'Reeks of guilt': Rahul on Shah's absence from Parliament

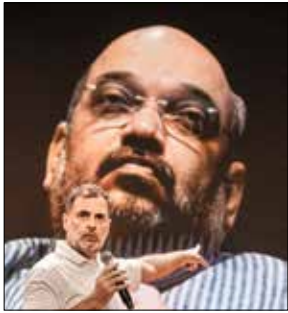
NEW DELHI: Home Minister Amit Shah's absence from Parliament "reeks of guilt", Leader of Opposition Rahul Gandhi said on Thursday as he reiterated his demand for a Supreme Court-monitored probe into the alleged police excesses against students.

Gandhi also shared on X a video clip of police lathi-charging students.

"Students deserve justice. An independent SC-monitored high powered committee must be constituted to probe brutalities against our students," he said on the social media site, referring to the crackdown on agitators by security forces during the July 20 Cockroach Jana Party-led protest march to Parliament and on student demonstrators in other parts of the country.

In another post, Gandhi asked why Shah is "so scared" of coming to Parliament and explaining the brutal violence against students.

"It reeks of guilt," he added.



Gandhi also on Wednesday demanded the sacking of Shah and the constitution of a Supreme Court-monitored probe into what he claimed was a "brutal attack" on protesting students and the use of pellet guns on them.

The former Congress president alleged that by ordering the "brutalities" on students, Shah was culpable and hence should be removed. He said that in case the minister did not know about the use of pellet guns on protesters, he was incompetent. The BJP hit back, accusing Gandhi of telling a "bundle of lies and demanded he apologise for 'misusing' the House by making "baseless" allegations.

Anurag Thakur moves privilege notice against Rahul over remarks

NEW DELHI: BJP MP Anurag Thakur on Thursday submitted a notice of breach of privilege and contempt of the House to Lok Sabha Speaker Om Birla against Leader of Opposition Rahul Gandhi for what he termed as "use of unparliamentary and derogatory language and levelling grave and unsubstantiated allegations" against Home Minister Amit Shah.

In the three-page notice, Thakur also requested Birla to refer this matter to the Privilege Committee for a detailed enquiry and appropriate action, including a direction to Gandhi to tender an unconditional apology to the House as well as to Shah.

Referring to the proceedings of the House on July 29, when the debate on the anti-paper leak bill was taking place, Thakur said Gandhi violated Rule 352 while narrating a purported conversation with protesting students. "Use of unparliamentary and derogatory language (violation of Rule 352):- During his address to the House, Shri Rahul Gandhi, while narrating a purported conversation with a student, categorised persons into three classes, 'students', 'idiots' and 'andhbhakt's, the latter two terms being used to characterise citizens and, by clear implication, political opponents and supporters of the government."

Thakur, an MP from Himachal Pradesh, said this drew

immediate objection from the Parliamentary Affairs Minister Kiren Rijiju, who demanded that the words be expunged as unparliamentary. But still, he said, Gandhi has repeated the words, even after being warned by the chair. The terms 'idiot' and 'andhbhakt' fall within the category of words that successive Lok Sabha Secretariat compilations of unparliamentary expressions have held unfit, alongside terms such as 'foolish', 'incompetent'. Their use is a direct violation of Rule 352(ii), which bars a member from making personal references by way of imputing a motive to, or questioning the bona fides of, any person unless necessary to the debate.

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BJP and SP turn to saints and social reformers as battle for UP polls heats up

Both parties are courting influential communities through symbolic campaigns

BISWAJEET BANERJEE

LUCKNOW: Even before the Election Commission announces the schedule for the 2027 Uttar Pradesh Assembly elections, the ruling Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) and the opposition Samajwadi Party (SP) have opened a new political front by competing to celebrate saints, social reformers and community icons revered by influential caste groups.

The outreach, which began quietly earlier this year, is expected to continue until February 2027, underscoring how identity politics has once again moved to the centre of the state's electoral strategy.

The BJP on July 29 launched its seven-month Samrasta Sankalp Abhiyan dedicated to Sant Ravidas Maharaj.

Political observers say the celebrations are less about paying tribute and more about consolidating caste constituencies that could prove decisive in the Assembly elections.

"Caste remains the defining factor in Uttar Pradesh politics. Every influential community has icons who command enormous social respect. By celebrating them, political parties seek to establish an emotional connection," political analyst Rajinder Kumar said.

The BJP's focus on Sant Ravidas is significant because he is revered by the Chamar community, including Jatav, Dhusia and Jhusia sub-groups. Together, they constitute around 11.25 percent of Uttar Pradesh's population and nearly 54 percent of the state's Scheduled Caste population. The community has a strong presence across all 75 districts, particularly in western and central Uttar Pradesh.

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CM Yogi Adityanath has already announced that Bhadohi will be renamed Sant Ravidas Nagar, reinforcing the BJP's outreach towards Dalit communities. The SP is pursuing a similar strategy through its PDA, or Pichhda, Dalit and Alapsankhyak, campaign. Its decision to celebrate Maharaja Daksha Prajapati is aimed at reaching the Prajapati or Kumhar community, an Other Backward Class group estimated to account for around 2 to 3 percent of Uttar Pradesh's population. While Hindu scriptures describe Daksha Prajapati as a mind-born son of Lord Brahma and the father of Goddess Sati, SP leaders identify him with the Prajapati community because of his title. The party's next programme honouring Janeshwar Mishra is expected to reinforce its traditional socialist credentials while reaching backward caste voters. Kumar said Uttar Pradesh's electoral history explains why parties invest heavily in symbolic politics.

He cited the rise of former bandit-turned-politician Phoolan Devi as a turning point in the political assertion of the Mallah community.

OFFICE OF THE RESIDENT COMMISSIONER
GOVT. OF MADHYA PRADESH, MADHYA PRADESH BHAWAN
PLOT NO. 29 C-D, JESUS & MARY MARG,
CHANAKYAPURI, NEW DELHI-110021
Phone No. 011-26772001, 2002

CORRIGENDUM-II

Dated: 28/07/2026

The NIT for "Hiring Agencies for Taxi Services" for MP Bhawan & Madhyanchal, New Delhi - 110021 against NIT No. 13/Hiring Taxi Services/MPB/2026 dated 06.07.2026 few modifications/ amendments made as follow:

- "Minimum Amount" mentioned in Column 1st of the 5th Row in Section-11 now to be read as "Base Amount"
- "1% of approved full day rate for per KM + Rs. 250 for Night Halt Charges" mentioned in last Column of last Row in Section-11 now to be read as "1% of approved full day rate for per KM + Rs. 400 for Night Halt Charges"
- "For extra per Hrs. - 5% of approved full day rate" mentioned in Section-11 (Note-2) now to be read as "For extra per Hrs. - 10% of approved full day rate"
- "The average annual turnover of the firm from transport services/ hiring of taxi should not be less than Rs. 6.00 Crores in any three financial years of the last 4 financial years i.e. 2022-23, 2023-24, 2024-25 and 2025-26 (provisional) duly certified by Chartered Accountant" mentioned in Section-7 Clause 7.2.5 now to be read as
"The minimum value of average annual turnover of the firm from transport services/ hiring of taxi in any three financial years of the last 4 financial years i.e. 2022-23, 2023-24, 2024-25 and 2025-26 (provisional) should be duly certified by Chartered Accountant be as mentioned below: -

S. N.	Category	Description	Annual Estimated Amount	Average Annual Turnover
	1	2	3	4
1.	Category-1 (Premium SUV)	Should have minimum 03 vehicles (Fortuner)	Rs. 6,00,000/-	Rs. 18,00,000/-
2.	Category-2 (Premium SUV)	Should have minimum 12 vehicles (Innova Crysta/ Innova Hycross/ Maruti Invicto)	Rs. 80,00,000/-	Rs. 2,40,00,000/-
3.	Category-3 (MUV)	Should have minimum 07 vehicles (KIA Carens/ Ertega/ Marazzo/ Rumion)	Rs. 40,00,000/-	Rs. 1,20,00,000/-
4.	Category-4 (Premium Sedan)	Should have minimum 10 vehicles (Ciaz, Honda City and Verna)	Rs. 60,00,000/-	Rs. 1,80,00,000/-
5.	Category-5 (Sedan)	Should have minimum 05 vehicles (Swift Dzire, Xcent, Honda Amaze, Etios)	Rs. 14,00,000/-	Rs. 42,00,000/-

If a bidder wishes to apply in more than one category of vehicles, then the bidder's average annual turnover should be the sum of average annual turnovers of respective vehicle categories. For example, if a bidder wishes to bid for categories 1, 2 & 5 then the average annual turnover should be Rs. 3.00 crore (Rs. 0.18 cr. + 2.40 cr. + 0.42 cr.). Similarly if a bidder wishes to bid for all the five categories, then the average annual turnover should be Rs. 6.00 crore"

Others terms & conditions will remain same.

Addl. Resident Commissioner
M.P. Bhawan, New Delhi

G16467/26

"स्वभाव स्वच्छता, संस्कार स्वच्छता"

ON POLICY & TECHNICAL MATTERS

PM’s Facebook post removal: Govt to hold discussions with Meta

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: The government will hold discussions with social media major Meta on policy and technical matters within a week over several concerns, including the removal of Prime Minister Narendra Modi’s Facebook post, a senior government official said on Thursday.

The government has summoned Meta’s public policy head after Prime Minister Narendra Modi’s Facebook post, on July 23, addressing India’s youth and promising stringent measures against exam paper leaks, was briefly restricted by the US-headquartered social media giant.

While speaking to reporters on the sidelines of the CII conference on semiconductors, Electronics and IT Secretary S Krishnan said that the government has asked Meta to come in at the highest level and explain the issue that led to the glitch. “They will be coming and explaining what the situation is. We want to have both a policy-level and a technical understanding of the issues, and an adaptation to the kinds of concerns India has in this regard. There are several issues we have, which we will raise with them when they come. I think, within the next week, they will be coming,” he said.

Meta, the owner of social media platform Facebook, is learnt to have written to the government outlining the specifics of enhanced and rigorous safeguards it has now implemented for content posted by Prime Minister Narendra Modi and other prominent accounts.

While the social media giant attributed the incident to a technical glitch and apol-

HIGHLIGHTS

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REPRESENTATIVE PIC

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» While the social media giant attributed the incident to a technical glitch and apologised, the MeitY found the explanation ‘inadequate’

ogised, the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY) found the explanation “inadequate”.

Meta has now informed the ministry that posts by the Prime Minister and select prominent accounts will be subject to additional oversight on the platform, with multiple levels of checks involving senior company officials, sources said.

Any decision will undergo rigorous checks and require review by at least two senior officials of the company, sources said, citing the social media firm’s latest communication to the ministry.

Meta has expressed regret over the incident, and explained the circumstances that led to it, sources said, adding that the company has also outlined the corrective measures it has since implemented, and shared its assessment.

Krishnan said Meta has to

give reasons on the cause that led to the incident.

“They have also given us the reasons, their understanding of the reason why it happened. They have also indicated that as of July 28, they have established new protocols relating to accounts of prominent persons to avoid such a situation from occurring,” he said.

PM Modi’s July 23 Instagram post, later shared on Facebook, marked his first direct selfie video aimed at engaging with the youth and underscoring the government’s commitment to crack down on exam paper leaks amid students’ protests organised by the Cockroach Janta Party. The Facebook version of the post was briefly restricted by Meta before being restored.

Following the incident, the global head of public policy of Meta (Facebook and Instagram) was summoned by MeitY.

SC permits Friday namaz on dargah land near Bhojshala complex at Dhar

Ensure Muslims are allowed to offer Friday namaz at site: Top Court to MP govt

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: The Supreme Court on Thursday permitted Muslims to offer Friday prayers at the premises of a dargah adjacent to the disputed Bhojshala complex at Dhar in Madhya Pradesh.

The top court directed the state government to ensure that Muslims are allowed to offer namaz at the site between 1 and 3 pm on Fridays.

A bench comprising Chief Justice Surya Kant and justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana, however, said that the instant direction does not preclude the state government and the Muslim side from exploring another site for Friday prayers with mutual consent.

On July 14, the bench had directed that a separate open space be provided adjacent to the disputed site in Dhar for



REPRESENTATIVE PIC

namaz on Fridays between 1 and 3 pm till the case is decided.

Later, the Muslim side led by Haji Muneer Ahmad moved the top court alleging non-compliance with its directions to provide an alternative site, saying that the Dhar administration was providing the place which was 1.3 km away from the disputed Bhojshala complex. They said that the site should be close enough from where Muslims can sight the mosque while offering prayers.

After hearing arguments from senior advocate Huzefa

Ahmadi, appearing for the Muslim side, and Additional Solicitor General K M Natraj, on behalf of the state government, clarified its earlier order of July 14.

“The earlier order is clarified to the extent that the Muslim community be permitted to offer namaz on Fridays between 1-3 pm at the land being Khasra No. 596 which is stated to be Dargah land. Copy of the site plan produced shows that it has an independent and separate access road and therefore the said site appears to be suitable. It is adjacent to the subject premises,” the CJI said in the order. “This order shall not preclude both sides to opt for any other site with mutual consent,” the bench added.

During the hearing, Ahmadi said that although an application had been made to the Collector for allotment of

land, the authorities had identified a site that was not sufficiently close to the Bhojshala complex. He said the allotted site was around 1.3 km away by road and around 900 m away in terms of radius.

He said suitable Waqf plots adjacent to the Bhojshala complex were available and the state administration was denying them on the ground of law and order. He referred to four possible locations around the complex, including dargah land adjoining the premises where Muslims can be allowed to offer Friday prayers.

“You can’t yield to the wrongdoer,” he submitted.

The additional solicitor general said that the government’s concern was limited to maintaining law and order and that it was not seeking to enter into the competing claims of the parties.

Govt: El Nino likely to intensify by Oct-Dec

NEW DELHI: The Ministry of Earth Sciences on Thursday informed the Rajya Sabha that El Nino conditions, which were weak in June, strengthened to moderate levels in July and are likely to intensify into a “very strong” phase between October and December this year.

In a written reply, Minister of State (Independent Charge) Jitendra Singh said the India Meteorological Department (IMD) has enhanced its forecasting capabilities under the Mission Mausam programme. The IMD currently operates six physical and three artificial intelligence-based numerical weather prediction models, along with a Multi-Hazard Early Warning Decision Support System.

For flood forecasting in the Brahmaputra basin, the Cen-

tral Water Commission maintains 32 forecast stations across Assam. AI and machine learning-based models have been introduced at eight of the region’s 12 short-range forecast stations to improve prediction accuracy. Ocean monitoring has also improved through real-time data from 302 Argo floats, 19 subsurface moorings and an expanded tsunami warning network. These measures have increased wave forecast accuracy by around 43 per cent since 2014, while coastal forecasts now achieve nearly 70 per cent accuracy.

The ministry acknowledged challenges in mountainous regions, stating that an X-Band Doppler Weather Radar could not be installed in Himachal Pradesh’s Lahaul and Spiti due to terrain constraints. MPOST

CHANDIGARH: Haryana Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini on Thursday accused the Congress and INDIA bloc parties of practising double standards, alleging that their public statements are at odds with their actions, particularly on the issue of examination paper leaks.

Speaking to mediapersons on the sidelines of the concluding ceremony of the 77th state-level Van Mahotsav in Karnal, Saini said the proverb ‘Hathi ke dant dikhaane ke aur, khaane ke aur’ aptly describes the Opposition’s politics. He alleged that while Congress and its allies make lofty promises, their conduct tells a different story.

Targeting the AAP-led Punjab government over the alleged paper leak issue, Saini termed the situation “extremely



FILE PIC

unfortunate” and questioned the silence of Punjab Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann and Congress leader Rahul Gandhi. He claimed Punjab’s youth are protesting on the streets over the issue, but neither the state government nor the Congress has shown concern.

Saini alleged that the controversy has exposed the AAP government’s failure to protect students’ interests, saying it has jeopardised the future of young aspirants and left them feeling betrayed. In contrast, he said, Prime Minister Nar-

UP: 2 killed as truck crashes into house

MIRZAPUR: A man and his teenage son were killed after a cement-laden container truck veered off the road and crashed into their house here in the early hours of Wednesday, police said on Thursday.

Additional Superintendent of Police (City) Nitish Singh said the accident occurred near Kalna Gaharwar in the Gaipura police outpost area under Vindhyachal police station limits.

The container, coming from Prayagraj, went out of control, crashed into a house and overturned, killing Shiv Prasad Gupta (45), who was sleeping on a cot, on the spot, he said.

Shiv Prasad’s 13-year-old son, Rohit, sustained serious injuries and was rushed to the district hospital by ambulance, where he died during treatment, the officer said. MPOST

Saini accuses Congress, INDIA bloc parties of ‘double standards’

Hooda calls Fasal Bima Yojana a ‘deception’ for farmers

CHANDIGARH: Former Haryana Chief Minister and Leader of the Opposition Bhupinder Singh Hooda on Thursday alleged that the Pradhan Mantri Fasal Bima Yojana (PMFBY) has failed to benefit farmers and instead enriched private insurance companies at their expense.

Hooda claimed the crop insurance scheme had become “a deception” for farmers, alleging that the number of beneficiaries had fallen from around 24 lakh in 2018-19 to nearly 11 lakh in 2024-25. He also criticised the state government for issuing the Kharif crop insurance notification on July 24, instead of the usual June 20-25 period, leaving nearly 11.20 lakh farmers barely a week to register.

He demanded an extension of the registration deadline and urged the government to clear all pending compensation without delay. Hooda also questioned why insurance premiums had increased while compensation paid to farmers had declined over the years.

Citing figures shared by Union Minister of State for Agriculture and Farmers’ Welfare Ramnath Thakur, Hooda said Haryana farmers received crop insurance claims worth Rs 2,518.66 crore in 2022-23, which fell sharply to Rs 265.23 crore in 2023-24 and further to Rs 262.6 crore in 2024-25.

According to him, insurance companies collected premiums of Rs 648.1 crore in 2023-24 but paid claims of only Rs 265.23 crore, while in 2024-25 they received Rs 1,056.7 crore in premiums from farmers and the Centre and state governments combined, against claims of Rs 262.6 crore.

Alleging that insurance firms were profiting at the cost of farmers and the public exchequer, Hooda said claim settlement lacked transparency, with farmers having no representation in crop loss assessment committees. MPOST

Himachal history, folk culture & cuisines to be part of textbooks

ASHWANI SHARMA

SHIMLA: Himachal Pradesh’s history, its unique folk culture, profiles of Kargil War heroes, and cuisines will be part of the textbooks for classes six to eight.

This was announced by Education minister Rohit Thakur after a meeting to review the textbooks for school education.

“The meeting held detailed discussions on incorporating key aspects of Himachal Pradesh’s geography, society, history, folk culture, economy, and political system into the curriculum for students of classes six, seven, and eight,” said the Education minister.

He informed that the revised textbooks would include engag-

ing and informative content on Himachal Pradesh’s journey from the prehistoric era to the state’s formation. The curriculum would also cover the state’s dialects, traditional cuisine, freedom fighters, Kargil heroes, soldiers, contemporary challenges, economy, political system, and other significant aspects of Himachal’s rich heritage and identity. Thakur said the content and factual material would be finalised within one month to facilitate the early publication of the revised textbooks. These books will be introduced in schools from the academic session 2027-28.

“By introducing students to authentic information and facts about Himachal Pradesh, we will foster analytical thinking, deepen their understanding of

the state’s history and culture, and stimulate curiosity for further learning,” he said, adding that the revised curriculum would also prove beneficial for students preparing for future competitive examinations.

The minister further stated that a committee has been constituted under his chairmanship to review and improve the curriculum for Classes 6, 7, and 8. The committee has been holding regular meetings to ensure the timely preparation and implementation of the revised textbooks. The panel comprises the Secretary of Education, representatives of the Himachal Pradesh Board of School Education, the State Council of Educational Research and Training (SCERT) and assistant professors, among others.

Pellet injuries can cause irreversible damage despite treatment: Experts

‘Severity depends on firing distance, impact velocity & organs affected’

NEW DELHI: As Parliament continues to witness debate over the alleged use of excessive force and pellet guns against student protesters, medical experts have warned that pellet gun injuries can cause irreversible damage, particularly when they involve major nerves, blood vessels, bones or vital organs.

The issue gained prominence after students protesting against the alleged NEET paper leak on July 20 were dispersed while marching from Jantar Mantar towards Parliament.

According to the RAF, however, only anti-riot equipment and two rounds of non-lethal plastic pellets were used during the operation.

Explaining the nature of such injuries, Shalini Solanki,

KEY POINTS

» The issue gained prominence after students protesting against the alleged NEET paper leak on July 20 were dispersed while marching from Jantar Mantar towards Parliament

» Police used tear gas and batons during the protest, while images and videos



REPRESENTATIVE PIC

circulating online showed several students with pellet injuries

» Protesters alleged that the Rapid Action Force (RAF) fired metal pellets, causing cluster injuries

faculty member at the School of Studies in Forensic Science, Samrat Vikramaditya Vishwavidyalaya, said a pellet cartridge differs from a conventional firearm bullet as it releases multiple small pellets instead of a single projectile.

“The severity of injury depends not only on the number of pellets striking the body but also on factors such as firing distance, pellet size, impact velocity, angle of impact and, most importantly, the anatomical structures involved,”

she said. Doctors said injuries involving tissues with limited regenerative capacity, including major nerves, blood vessels, bones, joints, the spinal cord and vital organs, may lead to chronic pain, long-term disability or permanent loss of function despite timely treatment.

One of the injured students, teenager Sahil Lochab, may lose vision in his right eye. His family claimed doctors informed them that the pellets causing the injury were made of metal. Several other students report-

edly sustained injuries to the face, neck, chest, arms and legs.

Dr Nikhil Valsangkar, Senior Consultant and Unit Head, Department of Orthopaedics and Robotic Joint Replacement at Sarvodaya Hospital, Greater Noida West: “Pellets fired from a distance generally cause multiple superficial wounds. At close range, however, they bunch together and strike as a single mass, resulting in severe tissue destruction, extensive bleeding and significant soft-tissue loss,” he said. He added that while superficial wounds and injuries to skeletal muscles often heal well, damage involving extensive soft-tissue loss, bone defects or disruption of nerves and blood vessels is frequently irreversible.

Dr Sakshi Singhal, Consultant, Surgical Oncology at Yatharth Hospital, said permanent consequences of pellet injuries can include blindness, hearing loss, chronic pain, joint stiffness and psychological trauma, including post-traumatic stress disorder. PPI

IHW Council unveils Mission Fertility 2.1

SHIVANGI SHUKLA

NEW DELHI: The Integrated Health & Wellbeing (IHW) Council launched Mission Fertility 2.1 on World IVF Day, calling for fertility care to become more accessible, affordable and dignified for Indian couples. The initiative was unveiled at the 7th India IVF Summit & Awards 2026 along with a white paper recommending reforms in insurance, public financing, awareness and workplace fertility benefits.

According to the Council, nearly 3.5 crore couples in India face infertility, but only about 42 lakh have access to treatment.

The white paper proposes recognising infertility as a core reproductive health condition, expanding awareness through ASHAs, schools and workplaces, and improving insurance coverage. It also recommends a fertility benefit package under PM-JAY.

The summit concluded with a commitment to translate the recommendations into policy.

Passport fraud case: Special CBI court convicts Chota Rajan

NARESH BISWANI

NEW DELHI/CHENNAI: A Special CBI Court on Thursday convicted underworld don Chota Rajan, alias Vijaya Kadam, in a passport fraud case and sentenced him to seven years’ rigorous imprisonment along with a fine of Rs 55,000 for offences including cheating, forgery, personation and using forged documents to obtain an Indian passport.

Rajan, whose real name is Rajendra alias Nana, is currently lodged in Tihar Jail, where he is serving a life sentence.

The case dates back to March 19, 2002, when the Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI) registered an FIR following a complaint alleging that Rajan had secured an Indian passport from the Regional Passport Office in Chennai by submitting forged documents.

During the investigation, the agency found that Rajan had applied for the passport in the name of Vijaya Kadam using fabricated documents, including a school transfer cer-

He was sentenced to seven years' rigorous imprisonment

tificate, ration card, demand draft and other records, to establish his identity, age and residence.

The CBI said the accused impersonated Vijaya Kadam and fraudulently obtained the passport by presenting forged documents as genuine. Investigators established that the applicant was, in fact, Rajendra alias Nana Chota Rajan, son of Sadashiv and a resident of Mumbai. Following the investigation, the CBI filed a chargesheet before the Special Court on January 22, 2004, charging Rajan with cheating, forgery, personation and knowingly using forged documents to obtain the passport.

The Special CBI Court found him guilty and awarded a seven-year jail term and imposed a fine of Rs 55,000. The sentence will be in addition to the life imprisonment Rajan is already serving in Tihar Jail.



EDITORIAL
BEYOND
ANONYMITY

For much of the past decade, cryptocurrencies occupied a curious legal and regulatory space in India. They were neither recognised as legal tender nor prohibited outright. Investors paid a steep 30 per cent tax on gains, exchanges complied with anti-money laundering requirements, and yet the broader ecosystem remained characterised by uncertainty. The government taxed digital assets without fully integrating them into the country's financial reporting architecture. That contradiction is now beginning to disappear. The Central Board of Direct Taxes' (CBDT) guidance note on crypto-asset reporting obligations is not about imposing a new tax or introducing additional compliance burdens on ordinary investors. Instead, it seeks to ensure that crypto transactions become visible to the tax administration in much the same way as banking transactions already are. Under the new framework, Reporting Crypto-Asset Service Providers (RCASPs), including cryptocurrency exchanges and certain intermediaries, will have to identify customers, establish their tax residency, conduct due diligence, maintain detailed transaction records and report annual information to the Income Tax Department. The move aligns India with the Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development's (OECD) Crypto-Asset Reporting Framework (CARF), which aims to facilitate the automatic exchange of tax-related crypto information among participating countries from 2027 onwards.

The significance of the CBDT's guidance lies less in taxation than in information. For years, tax authorities depended largely on voluntary disclosures by investors, even as crypto assets moved across borders with remarkable ease. Unlike traditional financial instruments, cryptocurrencies can be transferred between private wallets, overseas exchanges and decentralised platforms without passing through conventional banking channels. This created an obvious challenge for regulators. While blockchain technology records every transaction permanently, linking those transactions to specific taxpayers remained difficult without institutional reporting mechanisms. The new framework attempts to bridge that gap precisely. Exchanges will become the principal reporting entities, much like banks report financial information under existing domestic and international standards. This is neither unusual nor excessive. Modern tax systems increasingly rely on third-party reporting because self-reporting alone cannot ensure compliance in highly complex financial markets. Honest taxpayers should therefore have little reason to fear the guidance note. It does not introduce fresh tax rates, new return forms or additional filing obligations for individuals. Instead, it makes accurate record-keeping more important because tax authorities will now possess independent transaction-level information against which disclosures can be verified. Investors who have consistently declared their crypto income and maintained documentation of purchases, sales, transfers and wallet movements will simply find themselves operating within a more structured compliance framework. Those relying on fragmented reporting, incomplete disclosures or the mistaken belief that crypto transactions remain invisible to authorities will find that assumption increasingly untenable. Greater transparency also benefits the industry itself.

Yet transparency, valuable though it is, cannot become a substitute for coherent regulation. India's cryptocurrency policy continues to reflect an uneasy balance between acceptance and hesitation. On one hand, the government taxes crypto transactions, mandates reporting, and actively participates in global initiatives such as the OECD's Crypto-Asset Reporting Framework. On the other, it has yet to provide a comprehensive legal framework that clearly defines the status of crypto assets, the responsibilities of service providers, the rights of investors and the scope of regulatory oversight. This ambiguity imposes real costs. India possesses one of the world's largest communities of blockchain developers, fintech entrepreneurs and digital innovators. Regulatory uncertainty discourages investment, complicates business planning and encourages startups to establish themselves in jurisdictions where policy frameworks are more predictable. Compliance measures should therefore evolve alongside regulatory clarity rather than replace it. Equally important are concerns relating to privacy and data protection. The reporting framework requires exchanges to collect and share substantial volumes of financial information with tax authorities. Such powers are justified where they help combat tax evasion, money laundering and illicit financial flows, but they must be accompanied by rigorous safeguards against misuse, unauthorised access and data breaches. As governments acquire greater visibility over digital financial activity, public trust will depend not only on effective enforcement but also on confidence that personal information will remain secure and be used only for legitimate purposes. Financial transparency and privacy are not mutually exclusive objectives; a mature regulatory system must be capable of protecting both simultaneously.

Ultimately, the CBDT's guidance note marks an important milestone in India's evolving digital economy because it acknowledges a simple reality: cryptocurrencies have matured beyond being a speculative curiosity. They now represent a significant financial asset class involving millions of investors, substantial capital flows and increasingly sophisticated trading ecosystems. Such markets cannot remain detached from the reporting standards that govern every other component of modern finance. Bringing crypto exchanges within a structured reporting framework strengthens tax administration, enhances international cooperation and reduces opportunities for evasion without imposing fresh tax liabilities on compliant investors. That is sound public policy. However, this should be viewed as the beginning rather than the culmination of India's crypto journey. The next challenge lies in building a regulatory architecture that balances innovation with accountability, encourages responsible entrepreneurship while protecting consumers, and provides certainty without stifling technological progress. The challenge now is to complement tax transparency with regulatory clarity, so that India emerges not merely as a vigilant tax administrator but as a confident participant in the rapidly evolving global digital financial ecosystem.

HISTORICAL
AMNESIA



SACHCHIDANAND JOSHI
THE WRITER
IS A MEMBER
SECRETARY OF
IGNCA

Invoking
Harappa and
pre-Islamic
heritage is
easy; rewriting
textbooks and
teaching children
an honest
history will be
the real test

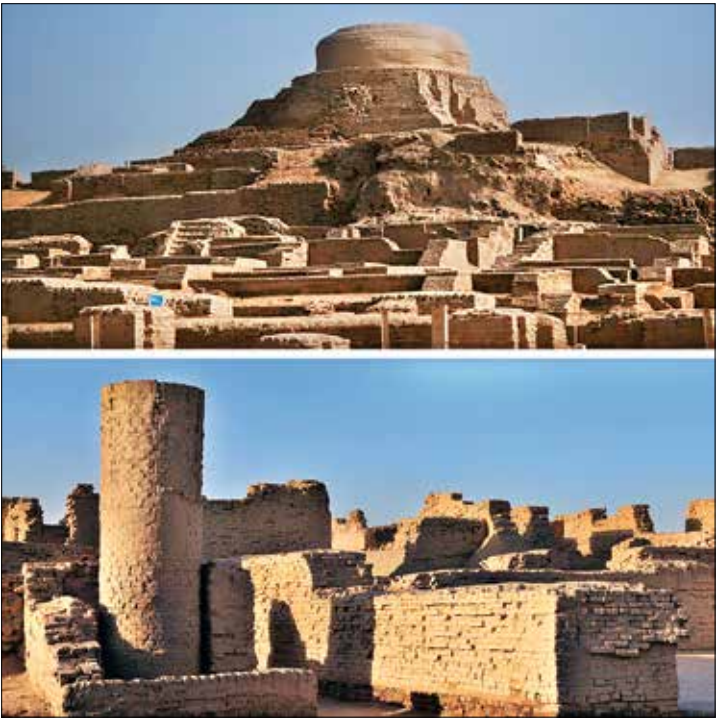
Pakistan's new embrace of the Indus civilisation may signal historical correction—or merely a strategic attempt to strengthen its diplomatic narrative and global image

For most of the last decade, if you wanted to find someone in Pakistan arguing that the country should stop pretending its history began in 712 AD with Muhammad Bin Qasim, you had to go looking for a handful of newspaper columnists and one out-of-print academic book. Today you can just watch a cabinet press conference. Government ministers now talk about the Indus, about Harappa, even about Sanskrit, with a comfort that would have been unthinkable in Pakistani public life twenty years ago. The question worth asking isn't whether this shift is real. It's why it took a water dispute to produce it.

The complaint itself is not new. Pakistan has had its own internal critics of historical amnesia for decades — they were simply never in government.

In 1993, the historian K.K. Aziz published a book that went through 66 Pakistani textbooks line by line and concluded that what students were being taught wasn't history at all, but what he called national mythology dressed up as fact. His argument wasn't that Pakistani history was too critical of the state. It was that there was barely any real history in it — that the pre-Islamic past, including the civilisation that gave the country its name, had simply been edited out because it didn't serve the story the state wanted to tell about itself. The book sold poorly, was never adopted into curriculum reform, and Aziz himself reportedly said he'd written it for posterity rather than for his own moment. He wasn't wrong to hedge his expectations. Nothing changed.

The columnist Nadeem Paracha picked up the same thread years later, tracing how the Zia-era curriculum didn't just neglect the Indus Valley but actively relocated Pakistani identity's point of origin to Arabia — a move critics at the time called an attempt to Arabise a population that had, inconveniently, mostly descended from people who were neither Arab nor originally Muslim. The physicist Pervez Hoodbhoy made a related argument from a different angle: that replacing a broad History curriculum with an ideologically narrower "Pakistan Studies" didn't just distort the past, it trained a generation out of the habit of questioning anything at all.



Mohenjo-daro symbolises Pakistan's ancient heritage, increasingly invoked officially but still absent from its national historical narrative

None of these were fringe cranks. They were a historian, a widely read columnist, and a physicist with an international reputation. And none of them moved the needle, because the problem was never a lack of scholarship. It was that no government had a reason to listen.

When India suspended its participation in the treaty following the 2025 Pahalgam attack, Pakistan suddenly needed a version of the Indus that belonged to it — not just as a river system it depends on for agriculture, but as a civilisational claim, something older and more legitimate-sounding than a bureaucratic water-sharing agreement. Around the same time, officials who would once have avoided the subject started talking openly about Hindu ancestry and pre-Islamic heritage. A defence minister acknowledging that most Pakistani Muslims descend from Hindu converts. An information minister calling the nation children of the Indus. A tourism budget for restoring Taxila and Harappa that didn't exist a

few governments ago.

Layer onto that the country's harder problem: a reputation, fairly or not, tied to instability and extremism, and very little in the international press to counterbalance it. An ancient civilisation is good material for a rebrand. It photographs well. It gives visiting diplomats something to admire besides a security briefing. None of this makes the archaeology less real — Mohenjo-daro is still one of the most significant Bronze Age sites on earth, regardless of who's currently using it to make a point. But it does mean the heritage is being reached for now because it's useful, not because the argument Aziz was making thirty years ago finally landed.

There's a version of this that would be straightforwardly good news: a country finally making peace with the full span of its own past, teaching it honestly, funding its preservation because the past is worth preserving rather than because it's worth marketing. That would be the vindication Aziz, Paracha and Hoodbhoy were arguing

for all along.

But a heritage ministry restoring ruins and a Pakistan Studies curriculum that still begins its story with the arrival of Islam are not the same government decision, even when they're made by the same government. Nothing about the current tourism push requires Islamabad to revisit what children are actually taught in school, and so far nothing suggests it has. You can fund the excavation of Harappa and still teach a version of national history in which Harappa barely exists as anything more than dirt beneath the flag. The site gets a budget line. The story stays the same.

That gap is the actual test of whether anything has shifted. Not whether officials can name-drop the Indus Valley Civilisation in a press conference — that's cheap, and increasingly it's obviously strategic. The test is whether the textbooks Aziz spent a career cataloguing ever get rewritten to include the fifty centuries of history that came before the seventh. Whether "Pakistan Studies" gives any ground back to something closer to just "history." Whether a state that spent decades building an identity in opposition to its own pre-Islamic past can hold both stories at once — the Indus civilisation and the founding ideology — without one having to quietly cancel out the other.

Owning a ruin is a matter of geography. Owning a past is a matter of what you're willing to teach your own children about where they came from. Pakistan has, for the moment, worked out how to do the first. Nobody serious is claiming it's worked out the second — including, if their earlier writing is any guide, the very Pakistani writers who first noticed the problem.

Civilisations are not public relations campaigns. They cannot be invoked only when they enhance a nation's international image and quietly ignored when they complicate its founding narrative. If Pakistan truly wishes to reclaim Panini, Harappa and the Indus as part of its inheritance, the real test lies not in speeches abroad but in classrooms at home. Heritage earns legitimacy not by being displayed before foreign audiences, but by being honestly taught to one's own children.

Views expressed are personal

SHARED
VICTORY



SHAILENDRA SHARMA
THE WRITER
SERVED AS AN
EDUCATION
ADVISOR TO
THE DELHI
GOVERNMENT
BETWEEN 2016-24

From PM
Modi and the
Opposition
to Sonam
Wangchuk and
India's Gen Z,
the CJP agitation
reshaped
political
equations far
beyond its
original demand

Politics of Strategic Retreat

What began as a campaign seeking the Education Minister's resignation evolved into a national democratic movement— energising young citizens and creating a new generation of leaders

Rarely does a mass movement end with every major stakeholder claiming some measure of success. The Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) movement demanding the resignation of Dharmendra Pradhan as India's Education Minister is one such rare moment. While Pradhan resigned, the movement also reshaped Indian politics by creating unexpected winners.

The most unlikely among them is Prime Minister Narendra Modi.

Many viewed his acceptance of Pradhan's resignation as a capitulation. Yet, by conceding to the protesters' principal demand, Modi demonstrated political pragmatism. His government initially followed its familiar script—questioning the motives of Sonam Wangchuk and other leaders, and attempting to weaken the movement by removing Wangchuk from Jantar Mantar. Instead, those actions strengthened public resolve and expanded youth participation.

The turning point came on July 20, when lakhs of young people marched towards Parliament. The scale of mobilisation caught the government completely off guard. Although police resorted to lathi charges and tear gas, protesters remained disciplined, preventing a confrontation that could have turned violent. As negotiations failed to defuse the movement and protests spread across the country, the government realised that the agitation had outgrown its organisers. Modi eventually chose strategic retreat over escalation. For a leader known for projecting strength, that decision arguably prevented a deeper national crisis. That restraint constitutes his share of the victory.



The CJP movement was much more than a campaign for one minister's resignation

The Opposition also deserves credit.

Rahul Gandhi and Akhilesh Yadav ensured that the issue remained alive inside Parliament by refusing to proceed with business while Dharmendra Pradhan remained Education Minister. Their protests outside Parliament complemented, rather than distracted from, the movement at Jantar Mantar, creating pressure on multiple fronts. The Samajwadi Party's visible presence on the streets, particularly Dimple Yadav's support for young protesters, reinforced the message that the movement had political backing without losing its independent character.

The Aam Aadmi Party also emerged stronger. Because Abhijit Dipke and Ashutosh Ranka had been associated with AAP, critics portrayed the movement as an AAP project. Yet the party leadership provided moral and material support without ever attempting to appropriate it. Arvind Kejriwal shared

the stage while allowing young leaders to remain at the forefront. Senior leaders joined the protests, and local workers sustained the movement by providing food, water, and logistical support. More importantly, the movement provided a template to the supporters of AAP to take their own initiative on public issues, just as Dipke and Ranka did.

Perhaps the biggest winner was India's Gen Z.

Within days, stereotypes portraying them as politically indifferent gave way to admiration for their creativity, discipline, and democratic spirit. Through slogans, memes, and social media campaigns, they challenged the aura surrounding Narendra Modi and demonstrated that they could not be manipulated by political messaging alone. By reclaiming public spaces and democratic participation, they reminded the country that accountability ultimately rests with an informed and engaged citizenry.

Sonam Wangchuk gave the movement its moral centre.

Already respected for his work in education and environmental conservation, he brought credibility and courage at a time when many feared confronting the state. His twenty-six-day fast transformed him from a regional activist into a national symbol of peaceful resistance and a youth movement.

Alongside him, three leaders of the All India Students' Association—Neha Bora, Manish Kumar, and Aameen Amitoj—remained on hunger strike for twenty-three days. Their commitment challenged attempts to dismiss student activism as "anti-national" and revived the historic role of students in shaping India's democratic movements. They also rekindled hope for a new generation of Left leadership.

The movement's greatest revelation, however, was Team Abhijit Dipke.

Along with Ashutosh Ranka and Saurav Das, they

answered a question frequently asked in Indian politics: "If not Modi, then who?" They are not alternatives to Narendra Modi, but they demonstrate that a nation of 1.4 billion people will never lack capable leaders. When the moment demanded leadership, they stepped forward with remarkable composure, resilience, and organisational skill. Their example reminds India that fresh leadership often emerges from movements rather than established political hierarchies.

Finally, even Dharmendra Pradhan can claim an ironic share of the victory.

Demand for his resignation united India across regions, ideologies and generations. More importantly, the movement has permanently elevated public expectations from the office of the Education Minister. Millions of young Indians now recognise that the position carries not only authority but also accountability. That may prove to be the movement's most enduring legacy.

The CJP movement was therefore much more than a campaign for one minister's resignation. It demonstrated that democratic protest, when disciplined, creative, and broad-based, can compel even the most powerful governments to listen. It strengthened the opposition, energised political parties without allowing them to dominate the movement, inspired a new generation of student leaders, elevated Sonam Wangchuk as a national moral voice, introduced promising young leadership, and restored confidence in India's democratic spirit. In that sense, it was not the victory of one party or one individual—it was a victory shared by all those who strengthened Indian democracy.

Views expressed are personal

AN IRANIAN STRIKE HIT CHINESE FIRM'S BUILDING

US, Iran trade missile barrages as hopes dim for quick resolution

CAIRO: The US and Iran each fired barrages of missiles Thursday, as the pattern of back-and-forth strikes took hold again and hope dimmed for any quick resolution.

After a brief respite, the risk of a return to all-out war emerged once more, with the fighting threatening to engulf even more countries: Jordan said Thursday it intercepted Iranian missiles for the second consecutive day, while Kuwait said a strike in the northern part of the country killed one person. Also this week, drones caused fires on ships at an Egyptian port, and Saudi Arabia said it came under fire from Iran-backed militias in Iraq.

The spiralling violence underscored the difficulty of winding down a five-month conflict that has sent the price of fuel and other basics soaring, jolted the world economy, and added to concerns about American stockpiles of weapons needed to defend its bases and allies.

After an earlier hiatus had given hope that diplomatic efforts were moving forward, there was no public sign of progress.

An Iranian strike hit a Chinese firm's building in Kuwait on Thursday, severely damaging the structure and kill-



An Israeli tank drives through Zawtar al-Sharqiya village, occupied by Israeli forces, as seen from the southern village of Zawtar al-Gharbieh, Lebanon

ing a worker, Kuwait's military said, hours after Jordan's air defences shot down five missiles launched from Iran.

No casualties were reported from Jordan's interception, Jordan's state-run Petra news agency said, quoting the spokesman for the country's armed forces.

Both countries are US allies and host American troops.

The attacks came after the US military said it completed

"a heavy wave of strikes against Iran," conducted in response to an earlier Iranian missile attack on a US base in Jordan. President Donald Trump vowed to hit Iran "very hard" after it targeted the base.

The military's Central Command said in a social media post that the US struck "dozens" of targets belonging to Iran's Revolutionary Guard, including military command centres as well as missile and drone

facilities, and coastal surveillance and defence sites.

Iran's official IRNA news agency said three people were killed and two were wounded in a strike on the island of Qeshm, which lies just off the Iranian mainland in the Strait of Hormuz — a crucial waterway for the world's energy supplies that has been at the centre of the conflict.

The latest barrage came after the US part-

Highlights

- » No casualties were reported from Jordan's interception
- » The latest barrage came after the US partnered with Saudi Arabia to strike Iran-backed militias in Iraq
- » Before the latest eruption, mediators had expressed optimism about bringing the US and Iran back to the negotiating table

nered with Saudi Arabia to strike Iran-backed militias in Iraq, killing at least 20 fighters and six Iranian advisers on Wednesday.

Before the latest eruption, mediators had expressed optimism about bringing the US and Iran back to the negotiating table.

A regional official said Wednesday that mediators are "still trying with both sides" to restore calm and get an interim agreement to end the war back on track.

He gave no details on whether progress was being made and spoke on condition of anonymity to discuss the closed-door diplomacy. AGENCIES

‘Pakistan doing its utmost to bring Iran, US back to table’

ISLAMABAD: Pakistan on Thursday said it was "doing its utmost" to bring the US and Iran back to the negotiating table under the Islamabad memorandum of understanding (MoU) signed last month, amid escalating tensions in the region.

"We support dialogue and diplomacy as they are the only viable path forward," Foreign Office spokesperson Tahir Andrabi said at his weekly press briefing here.

Andrabi said Pakistan was "doing its utmost" to revive negotiations between Washington and Tehran and resolve outstanding issues in the spirit of the Islamabad MoU and the Pakistan-Qatar joint statement of June 22.

He said Pakistan remained concerned over the precarious security situation in the Middle East despite a relative lull in hostilities over the past few days.

He said the pause had raised hopes that the positive development would lead to a durable and fully respected ceasefire and ultimately pave the way for the resumption of dialogue.

"We welcome all efforts aimed at sustaining cessation of hostilities and resumption of dialogue between the US and Iran," the spokesperson said, adding that negotiations were continuing to normalise the situation, particularly around the Strait of Hormuz, and to achieve de-escalation.

Andrabi urged both Wash-



The MoU between the US and Iran was signed on June 18 following weeks of intensive diplomacy

The MoU envisaged reopening the Strait of Hormuz and ending the conflict in the Middle East

ington and Tehran to exercise maximum restraint and honour their commitment to resume technical-level talks in accordance with the Islamabad MoU and the Pakistan-Qatar joint statement.

The MoU between the US and Iran was signed on June 18 following weeks of intensive diplomacy. It

envisaged reopening the Strait of Hormuz and ending the conflict in the Middle East, which began with US-Israeli strikes on Iran in February, after a further 60 days of negotiations.

The understanding, however, came under strain after hostilities resumed on July 7, when Iran attacked commercial shipping in the Strait of Hormuz, including a Qatari liquefied natural gas tanker, accusing the United States of violating the agreement.

The attack was followed by several waves of US strikes on Iranian military targets. AGENCIES

Hasina to be arrested on return to B'desh before court surrender: Min

DHAKA: Deposed Bangladesh prime minister Sheikh Hasina is likely to be arrested instantly on her return from India, before getting opportunities to surrender directly to a court, Law Minister M Asaduzzaman said on Thursday.

His comments came a day after Hasina told a news agency that she was determined to return to her country by December despite fearing for her life.

Earlier this month, there were more interviews of her that suggested she was discussing with her party col-



Deposed Bangladesh Prime Minister Sheikh Hasina

leagues her possible return to Bangladesh by the end of

this year. Asaduzzaman said 78-year-old Hasina has the right to return, but the "law will take its own course and we will do nothing violating the law".

"Despite being a death penalty convict, being a Bangladeshi citizen, if she intends to surrender showing respect to the law by returning home, perhaps she will be arrested before she could do so," the minister told reporters.

"We will exercise the authority that the law has given us." AGENCIES

Malaysia screens detained Myanmar nationals for repatriation of up to 5,000

PM says those being repatriated were Rohingya refugees

KUALA LUMPUR: Malaysia has started documenting and screening thousands of detained Myanmar nationals as part of a repatriation program agreed with Myanmar, Home Minister Saifuddin Nasution said Thursday.

Saifuddin said Myanmar had committed to accept up to 5,000 of its citizens currently living in Malaysia and an unspecified number currently in Cox's Bazar, a town in south east Bangladesh.

Malaysia had identified up

“WE WILL CERTAINLY MEET THE TARGET OF 5,000 INDIVIDUALS ONCE THIS PROCESS IS COMPLETE”

to 4,000 Myanmar nationals in its 19 detention depots, who will be moved to a single site for security screening and documentation purposes, he said.

"We will certainly meet the target of 5,000 individuals once this process is complete," Saifuddin told to reporters.

Foreign ministry officials could not be immediately reached for comment.

"People ask why we do not simply send them back. Send them where? Myanmar had refused to accept them before. Now, because of our good relations with Myanmar, they have agreed to take back 5,000 from Malaysia," Anwar said. AGENCIES

Hope dwindles for rescue in Japan quake as death tally reaches 25



Residents receive food supply, following an earthquake in Hikawa, Kumamoto Prefecture, on Thursday

KUMAMOTO: Rural communities in southwestern Japan were struggling to get their lives back to normal Thursday, two days after a powerful earthquake set off an explosion at a mall, toppled a factory chimney and flattened homes, killing at least 25 people.

Time was running out to find survivors, as rescuers continued to work in the Kumamoto area on Japan's southern main island of Kyushu, where the magnitude 7.1 earthquake hit Tuesday.

The number of those missing was unclear. Of the deaths given in the latest tally, 25 have been confirmed as related to the disaster, but there were nine more deaths

Key Points

- » The earthquake left at least 86 people injured, five of them seriously
- » Nearly 19,000 homes were still without electricity
- » Concerns were growing about illness, including from the sweltering heat

TIME WAS RUNNING OUT TO FIND SURVIVORS

under investigation as likely to be connected, the Kumamoto prefectural government said. AGENCIES

Curfew extends to new areas in Nepal

KATHMANDU: A teenager died on Thursday in clashes in Nepal's Madhesh province prompting authorities to extend curfew to more areas following communal violence in neighbouring Koshi province's Sunsari district, bordering India, earlier this week that left one person dead and several others injured.

The teenager died in the clashes that erupted in Golbazar market in Siraha district of Madhesh province, while one person, who was injured in the Sunsari violence, died in Koshi province, officials said.

This takes the death toll to three in the week-long communal violence that has hit Nepal's two provinces, Koshi and Madhes, both bordering Bihar.

Indefinite curfew was imposed in parts of Dhanusa, Siraha and Birgunj districts of Madhesh province on Thursday. AGENCIES

COURT NOTICE
(U/o 5 Rule 20 CPC)
IN THE COURT OF Ms. Meeta Kohli
Additional Civil Judge (Senior Division) Bhiwani
RadhaKishan S/o Fateh Singh R/o Alakhpura, Bawani Khara, Bhiwani Vs.
Ompati etc.
Case No. CS-327-2023
CNR No. HRBH02-000527-2023
Next Date 13-08-2026

Suit for partition
PUBLICATION ISSUED TO
11. SULEKHA RANI D/O BIRENDER SINGH S/O RAMJILAL
12. PARAMARKESH S/O BIRENDER SINGH S/O RAMJILAL
13. SUMAN SINGH S/O BIRENDER SINGH S/O RAMJILAL
14. NANHI D/O LEELA RANI D/O RAMJILAL
15. GUDDI D/O LEELA RANI D/O RAMJILAL
16. BABY D/O LEELA RANI D/O RAMJILAL ALL R/O- VILLAGE ALAKHPURA, BAWANI KHERA AT PRESENT TRIVENI, NEAR JOTRAM MANDIR GALI, BANK COLONY, BHIWANI
21. KAMLA DEVI WD/O JAGDISH S/O LEELARANI
22. NAVNEET SINGH S/O JAGDISH S/O LEELARANI
23. RACHNA D/O JAGDISH S/O LEELARANI
24. GEETA D/O JAGDISH S/O LEELARANI
26. BIMLA WD/O RAJENDER S/O JAWAHAR SINGH
27. ABHIMANYU S/O RAJENDER S/O JAWAHAR SINGH
28. PRIYANKA D/O RAJENDER S/O JAWAHAR SINGH
29. RUCHI D/O RAJENDER S/O JAWAHAR SINGH
30. MEENAKSHI D/O RAJENDER S/O JAWAHAR SINGH
31. DILJEET SINGH S/O JAWAHAR SINGH S/O HARJI RAM LRS OF DEF. NO 53 (I)- BABY D/O SURJEET SINGH S/O CHATTAR SINGH (II)-VIJAY LAXMI WD/O (III) DEPESH SON OF RAJESH S/O SURJEET SINGH ALL RESIDENT OF ALAKPURA, TEHSIL BAWANI KHERA, BHIWANI NOW R/O HOUSE NO.57, SECTOR 13 HISAR
In above titled case, the defendant (s)/ respondent(s) could not be served. It is ordered that defendant(s)/ respondent(s) should appear in person or through counsel on 13-08-2026 at 10:00 am. For details login to https://highcourtchd.gov.in/?mod=distict_notice&district=Bhiwani Sd/- Ms. Meeta Kohli Additional Civil Judge (Senior Division), Bhiwani Dated 29.07.2026

SYMBOLIC POSSESSION NOTICE

ICICI Bank

Branch Office: ICICI Bank Limited Plot No-23, Shal Tower, 3rd Floor, New Rohtak Road, Karol Bagh, New Delhi- 110005

The Authorised ICICI Bank Officer under the Securitisation, Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 and in exercise of the powers conferred under section 13(12) read with Rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules 2002, issued Demand Notices to the borrower(s) mentioned below, to repay the amount mentioned in the Notice within 60 days from the date of receipt of the said Notice.

Having failed to repay the amount, the Notice is issued to the borrower and the public in general that the undersigned has taken symbolic possession of the property described below, by exercising powers conferred on him/her under Section 13(4) of the said Act read with Rule 8 of the said rules on the below-mentioned dates. The borrower in particular and the public in general are hereby cautioned not to deal with the property. Any dealings with the property will be subject to charges of ICICI Bank Limited.

Sr. No.	Name of the Borrower(s)/ Loan Account Number	Description of Property/ Date of Symbolic Possession	Date of Demand Notice/ Amount in Demand Notice (Rs)	Name of Branch
1.	Mohammed Usman/ Alnaved Exports Private Limited/ Mohd Meharban/ Rehana Baby/ Shabista/ LBDEL00002443561	Cottage No. 8 & 9, Entire Basement & Ground Floor With Lawn (Without Roof Rights), With 60% Proportionate Un-Divided Share of Plot of Land Measuring 919.71 Sq Mtrs (Proportionate Plot Area Comes To 551.826 Sq Mtrs), (Out of Cottage No. 8 Having Its Area Measuring 500 Sq Yrds & Cottage No. 9 Having Its Area Measuring 600 Sq Yrds) Being Part of Property No. 4, Known As 4/8 And 4/9, Situated At Racquet Court Road, Civil Lines, Delhi- 110054/ July 28, 2026	April 28, 2026 Rs. 5,72,13,087.41/-	Delhi/NCR

The above-mentioned borrower(s)/guarantor(s) is/are hereby issued a 30 day Notice to repay the amount, else the mortgaged properties will be sold after 30 days from the date of publishing this Notice, as per the provisions under Rules 8 and 9 of Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules 2002.
Date: July 31, 2026
Place: Delhi/ NCR

Sincerely Authorised Officer,
For ICICI Bank Ltd.

KIND ATTENTION RAIL PASSENGERS!

IMPORTANT INFORMATION

EXTENSION OF PERIODICITY OF SUMMER SPECIAL TRAINS

This is notified for the information of Rail Passengers that Railways have decided to extend the Periodicity of the run of following Summer Special Trains as under:-

Train No.	Station		Frequency/ Days of Run	Earlier Notified Upto	Extended Period	Trips
	From	To				
09309	Indore Jn	Hazrat Nizamuddin	Bi-Weekly (Fri & Sun)	31.07.2026	Upto 30.08.2026	9
09310	Hazrat Nizamuddin	Indore Jn	Bi-Weekly (Sat & Mon)	01.08.2026	Upto 31.08.2026	9
09093	Udhna Jn	Ayodhya Cantt	Weekly (Fri)	31.07.2026	Upto 28.08.2026	4
09094	Ayodhya Cantt	Udhna Jn	Weekly (Sat)	01.08.2026	Upto 29.08.2026	4
09097	Udhna Jn	Ayodhya Cantt	Weekly (Tue)	28.07.2026	Upto 25.08.2026	4
09098	Ayodhya Cantt	Udhna Jn	Weekly (Wed)	29.07.2026	Upto 26.08.2026	4
09451	Gandhidham Jn	Bhagalpur Jn	Weekly (Fri)	31.07.2026	Upto 28.08.2026	4
09452	Bhagalpur Jn	Gandhidham Jn	Weekly (Mon)	03.08.2026	Upto 31.08.2026	4

Note: Rest of instructions will hold good.
For any other information passengers are requested to contact RailMadad Helpline No. 139 or may visit Indian Railways website <https://enquiry.indianrail.gov.in> or NTES App.

Visit RailMadad website:
www.railmadad.indianrailways.gov.in
Download RailMadad App.

NORTHERN RAILWAY

visit us at: www.nr.indianrailways.gov.in

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

Please join us on

PSPCL Punjab State Power Corporation Limited

GVK Power (Goindwal Sahib) Limited
Regd. Office: Plot No. 10, Paigah Colony, Sardar Patel Road, Secunderabad-500003, Telangana, India CIN U40109PL1997PLC028483
(A wholly owned subsidiary of Guna Amar Das Thermal Power Limited, GATPL)
(A step down wholly owned subsidiary of Punjab State Power Corporation Limited, PSPCL)
HOD-Chemistry, GATP, Goindwal Sahib, invites E-Tender for the supply of:
1. Tender Enquiry No. 182/GATP/CHEMISTRY/20018140 dated 30/07/2026
Supply of Sulphuric Acid Commercial Grade at GVKPGSL, Goindwal Sahib,
For detailed NIT & tender specifications, please refer to <https://eproc.punjab.gov.in> from 30/07/2026 from 17:00 Hrs. onwards
GATP-75/26 PR-Advt. No :- 1079/12/2026-27/13846

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED

(See Section 82 Cr. PC)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person namely **Boby Singh @ Nand Kishor S/o Suraj Pal R/o Sukr Bazar Road, Infront of SBI Bank ATM Vikas Nagar Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 465/2024 U/S 356/379/34 IPC at P.S.: Ranhola, Delhi** and it has been returned a warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said accused **Boby Singh @ Nand Kishor** could not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Boby Singh @ Nand Kishor** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person **Boby Singh @ Nand Kishor** of case **FIR No. 465/2024 U/s 356/379/34 IPC of P.S.: Ranhola, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before 13.01.2027.

By order
Ankit Karan Singh
Judicial Magistrate First Class-08
West District, Room No.30,
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/10346/OD/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 CrPC

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Rubel @ Suhel S/o Kabir R/o House No. 92/3/1A, Batla House, Jamia Nagar, New Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case registered vide **FIR No. 611/2020 U/S 420/34 IPC, PS Okhla Industrial Area, New Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest their upon issued that the said accused **Rubel @ Suhel** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Rubel @ Suhel** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Rubel @ Suhel** of **FIR No. 611/2020 U/S 420/34 IPC, PS Okhla Industrial Area, New Delhi** is required to appear before this court (or before me) to answer the complaint on or before the day of 02.09.2026.

By Order,
Ms. Akansha Gautam
Judicial Magistrate First Floor-02
South-East District
Saket Courts, New Delhi

DP/10568/SE/2026(Court Matter)

COURT NOTICE
(U/o 5 Rule 20 CPC)
IN THE COURT OF
Sh. Vineet Kumar
Civil Judge (Junior Division), Jhajjar
Noor Jihan Nand Giri Ji (Disciple and LRs.
Sh. Ishwaranand Giri Ji)
Vs.
Tehsildar / A.C. 1st Grade
CNR NO. HRJ02-000116-2026
NEXT DATE:- 31-08-2026
PUBLICATION ISSUED TO:
General Public
:-
India
In above titled case, the defendant(s)/ respondent(s) could not be served. It is ordered that defendant(s)/ respondent(s) should appear in person or through counsel on 31-08-2026 at 10:00 a.m. For details login to https://highcourtchd.gov.in/?mod=distict_notice&district=Jhajjar Sd/- Sh. Vineet Kumar Civil Judge (Junior Division) Jhajjar date 28.07.2026

‘India-EU FTA has comprehensive provisions to address CBAM issues’

Additional Secretary in the Department of Commerce Darpan Jain said there are provisions, such as extension of flexibility to India by the EU

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: There is a comprehensive work plan under the India-EU free trade agreement to address concerns over the European Union's carbon tax, a senior government official said on Thursday, expressing hope that domestic small and medium enterprises will not face any problems due to that measure.

Additional Secretary in the Department of Commerce Darpan Jain said there are provisions, such as extension of flexibility to India by the EU, if the 27-nation bloc extends relaxation to other countries.

CBAM (carbon border adjustment mechanism) took a lot of negotiating capital. In the text, there is a separate Annexure on dealing with CBAM, and there are certain pillars.

“The first pillar is that, in case of flexibility in future, that will be available to India. So there is an obligation in that,” he said.

“Second, CBAM compliances are a concern among SMEs in terms of verification, in terms of finding out what is the value of embedded carbon, in terms of ensuring that the verifiers are recognised by the EU authorities.



CBAM (carbon border adjustment mechanism) took a lot of negotiating capital. In the text, there is a separate Annexure on dealing with CBAM, and there are certain pillars.

“So, there are separate provisions, and we also have a provision in which we can engage with EU authorities on taking into account the carbon price, which is paid in India. As you would know, India also is developing its own carbon pricing mechanism. So, how to offset what is paid in India from what is paid in Europe, so even that is part of it,” Jain noted.

He was speaking at the IGCC (Indo-German Chamber of Commerce) Industry Dialogue 2026 here. He was replying to a question that MSMEs are apprehensive that the mechanism may affect their exports to the EU member nations.

“So, there is a comprehensive, I would say, work plan under annexure on CBAM and

HIGHLIGHTS

» So, there are separate provisions & we also have a provision in which we can engage with EU authorities on taking into account the carbon price, which is paid in India

» ‘As you would know, India also is developing its own carbon pricing mechanism. So, how to offset what is paid in India from what is paid in EU, is also a part of it’

» Carbon Border Adjustment Mechanism (CBAM) or the carbon tax came into effect on January 1

threshold during manufacturing. Presently, the tax applies to steel and aluminium products.

Jain also said that to spread awareness about the trade agreement, the commerce ministry has chalked out a very elaborate programme of outreach to almost all the different districts of the country.

“We want to go to all the districts and conduct outreach programmes there and tell industry about what is there in the FTA, how they can use it, how they can explore opportunities under that. We are also exploring other tools like electronic tools, so that we can engage with them, especially small businesses,” he said.

Both sides in January announced the conclusion of talks for the pact. It is expected to be signed later this year and may come into force next year.

Jain said the deal will provide huge business opportunities to both sides.

India and the EU trade is about one-third of the global trade, which is about \$33 trillion.

He said Germany is a powerhouse of auto, and its exports from the sector are about \$286 billion, and the pact provides huge opportunities for the European country in India.

Markets rally for 2nd day driven by buying in blue-chip stocks

OUR CORRESPONDENT

MUMBAI: Benchmark equity indices Sensex and Nifty ended higher on Thursday, driven by a rally in blue-chip stocks Reliance Industries, HDFC Bank and foreign fund inflows.

In a volatile session, the 30-share BSE Sensex ended 273.55 points, or 0.35 per cent, higher at 77,928.15, helped by lag-end buying.

The 50-share NSE Nifty advanced by 66.95 points, or 0.28 per cent, to end at 24,317.15.

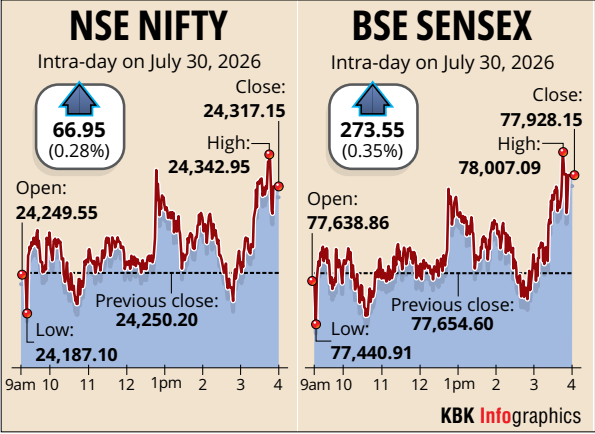
From the Sensex pack, Maruti Suzuki, Mahindra & Mahindra, Reliance Industries, State Bank of India, HDFC Bank and Power Grid were among the major winners.

Adani Ports, InterGlobe Aviation, Bajaj Finserv and Bharat Electronics were among the laggards.

Foreign Institutional Investors (FIIs) bought equities worth Rs 2,981.87 crore on Wednesday, according to exchange data.

“Markets traded in a volatile yet narrow range and settled marginally higher amid mixed cues. Sentiment remained mixed as the US Fed kept rates unchanged but signaled a hawkish stance, boosting rate hike expectations later this year. Further, Brent crude nearing the \$90 mark with renewed geopolitical concerns kept markets on edge,” Ajit Mishra – SVP, Research, Religare Broking Ltd, said.

However, stability in the rupee and stock-specific buying across sectors due to the



Among sectors, Auto rose 1.58%, Energy 0.73%, Consumer Discretionary 0.48%, Oil & Gas 0.38%, Top 10 Banks 0.20%, Metal 0.17% and Consumer Durables 0.13%

ongoing earnings season outcomes continue to support the recovery, he added. The BSE SmallCap Select index dipped 0.66 per cent and the MidCap Select index edged lower by 0.36 per cent.

Among sectors, Auto climbed 1.58 per cent, Energy 0.73 per cent, Consumer Discretionary 0.48 per cent, Oil & Gas 0.38 per cent, Top 10 Banks 0.20 per cent, Metal 0.17 per

cent and Consumer Durables 0.13 per cent.

Realty declined 2.10 per cent, Services 1.14 per cent, MidSmall Private Banks Quality Tilt 0.82 per cent, Insurance 0.69 per cent, Capital Goods 0.61 per cent, Industrials 0.42 per cent and Commodities 0.39 per cent.

Brent crude, the global oil benchmark, climbed 0.45 per cent to USD 91.15 per barrel.

In Asian markets, South Korea's KOSPI and Shanghai's SSE Composite index ended lower, while Japan's Nikkei 225 and Hong Kong's Hang Seng index settled in positive territory.

European markets were trading higher. US markets ended significantly lower on Wednesday.

The Sensex jumped 888.68 points, or 1.16 per cent, to settle at 77,654.60 on Wednesday. The Nifty climbed 264.85 points, or 1.10 per cent, to end at 24,250.20.

Rupee rises 26 paise to 95.50 against dollar

MUMBAI: The rupee stayed steady for the fifth straight session and settled with a gain of 26 paise at 95.50 against the US dollar on Thursday, taking cues from positive domestic equity markets and inflows of foreign capital.

According to forex traders, a softening dollar also supported the local currency, but its upward move was restricted due to volatile crude oil prices, triggered by a fresh escalation of the war in West Asia.

At the interbank foreign exchange, the rupee opened at 95.59 and traded in the range of 95.50 to 95.75 against the greenback. The local unit ended the session at 95.50 against the US dollar, registering a gain of 26 paise from its previous closing level.

The rupee gained 6 paise to settle at 95.76 against the US dollar on Wednesday, after rising 97 paise in four back-to-back sessions since closing at 96.73 versus US dollar on July 23.

“Traders may take cues from advance GDP, core PCE (Personal Consumption Expenditures) price index and weekly unemployment claims data from the US. USD-INR spot price is expected to move in a range of Rs 95.40 to Rs 96,” Anuj Choudhary, Research Analyst, Mirae Asset ShareKhan, said.

Meanwhile, the dollar index, which gauges the greenback's strength against a basket of six currencies, was trading down 0.05 per cent at 101.67.

Sebi issues operational framework to boost launch of AIF schemes

NEW DELHI: Markets regulator Sebi on Thursday introduced an operational framework for the Green-Channel: AIF Rollout Upon Document Acknowledgement (GARUDA) mechanism to simplify and accelerate the launch of Alternative Investment Fund (AIF) schemes.

The framework follows amendments to the Sebi (Alternative Investment Funds) Regulations, 2012, notified earlier this month. Under the new mechanism, AIFs launching regular schemes can commence operations 10 working days after filing the Placement Memorandum (PPM) with Sebi through a registered merchant banker, unless advised otherwise by the regulator.

For first-time schemes, the launch can begin from the date of Sebi registration or after completion of the 10-working-day



period from filing the application, whichever is later.

Sebi has introduced a simplified process for Accredited Investor-only (AI-only) funds, Large Value Funds (LVFs) and Angel Funds. These funds can launch schemes immediately after filing the PPM with Sebi and are exempt from filing through merchant bankers.

The regulator has mandated merchant bankers to conduct independent due diligence on disclosures in PPMs of regular

schemes and certify that the information is true, fair and adequate. Merchant bankers appointed for PPM filings cannot be associates of the AIF, sponsor, manager or trustee.

Sebi has also introduced disclaimer requirements in PPMs clarifying that filing documents with the regulator does not amount to approval and that managers and merchant bankers remain responsible for disclosure accuracy.

For AI-only funds, LVFs and Angel Funds, disclosure responsibility will rest with the AIF manager, supported by undertakings from the chief executive officer and compliance officer.

The circular, effective immediately, applies to AIF scheme PPMs filed after notification of the Sebi (Alternative Investment Funds) (Second Amendment) Regulations, 2026.

Exide Industries Q1 FY27 PAT rises 27% to ₹407 cr

NEW DELHI: Exide Industries Ltd on Thursday reported a 27.1 per cent year-on-year increase in its profit after tax (PAT) for the first quarter of FY27, supported by strong growth in revenue and operating profit.

The company's PAT stood at Rs 407 crore in the April-June quarter of FY27, compared with Rs 320 crore in the corresponding quarter of FY26.

Earnings per share (EPS) rose 27.1 per cent to Rs 4.79 from Rs 3.77 a year ago.

Revenue for the quarter increased 17.6 per cent to Rs 5,305 crore from Rs 4,510 crore in the year-ago period.

Earnings before interest, tax, depreciation and amorti-

sation (EBITDA) rose 19.5 per cent to Rs 655 crore during the quarter, as against Rs 548 crore in Q1 FY26.

The company's EBITDA margin improved by 20 basis points to 12.4 per cent of revenue from 12.2 per cent in the corresponding quarter of the previous fiscal.

Profit before tax (PBT) grew 26.4 per cent year-on-year to Rs 543 crore in the first quarter of FY27 from Rs 430 crore in the same period last year.

The company delivered broad-based growth across key financial parameters during the quarter, with higher revenue translating into improved operating performance and profitability.

Texmaco, Touax, TrinityRail JV plans to invest ₹1,800 crore in 100 rail rakes

NEW DELHI: Texmaco Rail & Engineering Ltd, Touax Group and TrinityRail Global have strengthened their partnership to expand railcar leasing operations in India, with the joint venture TTREL planning an investment of around Rs 1,800 crore to add 100 new rakes over the next three to five years.

The collaboration will operate through Touax Texmaco Railcar Leasing Private Limited (TTREL), combining Indian manufacturing, European leasing and asset management expertise and North American rail engineering capabilities.

Under the revised shareholding, Texmaco & Touax will each hold 34 per cent in TTREL, while TrinityRail, a subsidiary of

Trinity Industries, will own the remaining 32 per cent.

The joint venture will offer railcar design, manufacturing, financing, leasing, maintenance, lifecycle engineering and asset management, while aiming to introduce advanced rolling stock, improve asset utilisation, reduce maintenance costs and shorten production timelines.

Texmaco Rail & Engineering Chairman Saroj Kumar Poddar said the partnership would help build a future-ready rail freight ecosystem by integrating manufacturing, leasing and engineering capabilities.

Touax Group CEO Fabrice Walewski said the planned investment in 100 rakes would support India's growing freight

ecosystem by adding capacity and flexibility. He said leasing has transformed transportation industries globally and can play a key role in strengthening India's railway sector.

TrinityRail Chief Investment Officer Patrick Hurst said India offers one of the world's largest rail freight growth opportunities, with the company contributing expertise in wagon design, maintenance, financing, lifecycle optimisation and technology-enabled asset management. Both partners said the J would benefit from PM Gati Shakti, the National Logistics Policy and Dedicated Freight Corridors, supporting efficient, cost-effective and sustainable freight movement.

GAIL enters prestigious FTSE4Good Index Series

NEW DELHI: GAIL (India) Ltd, India's integrated energy major, has entered into the globally recognised FTSE4Good Index Series. The company has been awarded the FTSE4Good Index Certificate of Membership, following the June 2026 review by FTSE Russell.

The recognition underscores GAIL's unwavering commitment to maintaining high standards of Environmental, Social & Governance (ESG) performance.

It reflects the company's continued focus on environmental stewardship, social responsibility and robust

corporate governance, while aligning its sustainability initiatives with globally accepted ESG benchmarks.

The FTSE4Good Index Series is a leading global sustainable investment index that identifies companies demonstrating strong ESG practices based on internationally recognised standards.

FTSE Russell is a trading name of FTSE International Limited, Frank Russell Company, Refinitiv Benchmark Services (UK) Ltd and their respective group undertakings, all of which are members of the London Stock Exchange Group (LSEG).

CORPORATE KALEIDOSCOPE



REC Power Development and Consultancy Ltd (RECPDCL) hands over the SPVs of Bhadla Ramgarh Power Transmission Ltd and Shongtong Power Transmission Ltd to Power Grid Corporation of India Ltd (POWERGRID) and Terralight Solar Energy Tinwari Pvt Ltd, respectively, on Wednesday.

M&M Q1 profit jumps 34% to ₹5,455 crore

The company had delivered a PAT of Rs 4,083 crore in first quarter of FY26

MUMBAI: Mahindra & Mahindra Ltd (M&M) on Thursday reported a 34 per cent year-on-year increase in consolidated profit after tax (PAT) at Rs 5,455 crore for the first quarter of FY27, compared with Rs 4,083 crore in the year-ago period.

Revenue during the quarter stood at Rs 58,188 crore, registering a 28 per cent growth from Rs 45,529 crore in Q1 FY26. The company said its Auto and Farm segments continued to deliver growth and margin expansion, with profits rising 18 per cent year-on-year.

M&M sold 3,04,000 vehicles during the quarter, marking a 23



per cent annual growth, while sport utility vehicle (SUV) volumes reached 1,75,000 units. The company's financial services business reported 13 per cent growth in assets under management.

Tech Mahindra continued its margin expansion journey

with a 330 basis points improvement in EBIT, while Mahindra Logistics recorded 23 per cent revenue growth during the quarter.

M&M Group CEO and Managing Director Anish Shah said the company delivered strong results despite macroeconomic challenges, supported by its diversified portfolio and proactive measures. He added that the Auto and Farm businesses continued to strengthen their market positions, while Tech Mahindra, Mahindra Finance and other growth businesses made progress on strategic priorities.

Rajesh Jejurikar, Executive Director and CEO (Auto and Farm Sector), said the Auto and Tractor businesses showed resilience in Q1 FY27. SUV revenue market share increased 50 basis points sequentially, while light commercial vehicle volume market share improved 150 basis points.

M&M's tractor business gained 280 basis points sequentially to reach 44.9 per cent market share in the quarter. Amarjyoti Barua, Group Chief Financial Officer, said the company remains focused on value creation while maintaining a strong balance sheet.

Paresh Ranpara Takes Over as Director (Personnel), NHPC Limited

NEW DELHI: NHPC Ltd on Thursday announced that Paresh Ranpara has assumed charge as Director (Personnel). Ranpara joins NHPC from Grid-India, where he served as Director (Human Resources), leading human resource management, talent development, organisational capability building and workforce planning. A human resources professional with over 31 years of experience in the power sector across public and private organisations, Ranpara holds a Master of Social Work from The Maharaja Sayajirao University of Baroda and a Bachelor of Business Administration from Sardar Patel University. He is also a Certified Assessor from XLRI, Jamshedpur.



MP

IRFC posts record June qtr earnings, retains zero NPAs

IRFC registered total income of Rs 8,391.34 crore in Q1 FY27 against Rs 6,918.24 crore in Q1 of fiscal 2025-26

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Indian Railway Finance Corporation (IRFC), a Navaratna PSU of Indian Railways, has shown its best-ever quarterly performance by securing record revenue, profit, and net worth in the first quarter of FY 2026-27 despite maintaining its unique status of having no non-performing asset at all.

As per the unaudited stand-alone financial results of the company for the quarter ending on June 30, the total income of IRFC has come to Rs 8,391.34 crore as against Rs 6,918.24 crore for the same period of the last financial year.

The profit after tax (PAT) has increased to Rs 1,927.21 crore in the first quarter of FY 2026-27 from Rs 1,745.69 crore for the same period last year, thereby increasing the PAT by 10.4 per cent year-on-year.

This outstanding performance reflects the growing importance of the company not only as the railway financier but also as a player in the field of mobility and allied sectors. The net worth of the cor-



poration has also reached an all-time high of Rs 58,791.95 crore as on June 30 of this year as against Rs 56,748.76 crore as on March 31.

The net interest margin (NIM) recorded by the corporate entity was 1.48 per cent on an annualised basis for the period, which is a result of the benefits accrued through the diversification policy and effective liability management of the corporation.

The total amount of assets under management (AUM) of the corporation was Rs 4.79 lakh crore at the end of the period

compared to the Rs 4.85 lakh crore recorded at the end of the last fiscal year.

IRFC maintained its record of having zero non-performing assets, which was attributed to the nature of its asset management and risk management process despite expanding its lending activities outside railway funding.

On the performance, Chairman and MD of IRFC, Manoj Kumar Dubey, said that the results were an indication of the robustness of the diversification efforts of the company, which is being undertaken under the

HIGHLIGHTS

» The PAT has jumped to Rs 1,927.21 crore in Q1 FY27 as against Rs 1,745.69 crore for same period last year

» Net worth of IRFC has also jumped to all-time high of Rs 58,791.95 cr as on June 30, 2026 against Rs 56,748.76 cr as on March 31

IRFC 2.0 plan. He added that the company will continue to grow its presence in the various sectors and industries associated with the railways' ecosystem but will follow a cautious approach towards lending along with preserving the quality of its portfolio of assets.

It is expected that the strategy of diversification adopted by the corporation will help the company be profitable and generate returns during the ongoing fiscal year, owing to a rising pipeline of projects in the sectors of mobility and allied sectors.

India's gold demand declines 6% to 131.4 tonnes in April-June qtr: WGC

The total demand was at 139.7 tonnes during the corresponding period last year, according to WGC's 'Q2 2026 Gold Demand Trends' report

OUR CORRESPONDENT

MUMBAI: India's gold demand fell 6 per cent year-on-year to 131.4 tonnes in the April-June quarter, weighed down by seasonally subdued sales, higher Customs duty and Prime Minister Narendra Modi's appeal to reduce purchases of the precious metal, the World Gold Council said in a report.

The total demand was at 139.7 tonnes during the corresponding period last year, according to WGC's 'Q2 2026 Gold Demand Trends' report.

"However, it's been a record in terms of the value of demand. So, consumption was Rs 1,98,100 crores, compared with Rs 1,32,500 crores in the same period in 2025, which is up by 50 per cent compared to the second quarter of 2025, highlighting that consumers continue to prioritise gold even in a high-price environment," WGC Regional CEO, India, Sachin Jain told PTI.

Going forward, for the year, WGC estimated the demand to stay between 650 and 750 tonnes.

"We still see demand in the range of 650 to 750 tonnes for this year. However, given the



current geopolitical landscape, interest rates, and inflation, I think we should be somewhere in the middle of this range. If there is more correction in gold prices and the customs duty is reduced, then we could get to the upper end of this range," Jain added.

Total Jewellery demand in India during the quarter under review decreased by 15 per cent to 75.1 tonnes as compared to 88.8 tonnes in the same period last year.

"Subdued season, the clarification call of the Prime Minister to buy less gold and hike in Customs Duty, among others, impacted the demand," he added.

Prime Minister Modi, in May this year, urged people to

reduce non-essential gold purchases and explore other ways to save foreign exchange reserves amid mounting import bills of the country due to volatile crude oil prices.

Jain expressed concern about a rise in grey marketing after the duty hike, noting reports of illicit gold already making its way into these markets.

"We think smuggling and illicit gold making way into the market is the biggest risk to the industry, and we are already getting reports on this. We will be tracking this in the coming quarters," he added.

Meanwhile, investment demand remained encouraging, with bar and coin demand growing 9 per cent year-on-year

to 50.3 tonnes, while Indian Gold ETFs attracted 4.2 tonnes of net inflows despite global outflows.

"These trends reinforce gold's growing appeal not only as a traditional store of wealth but also as a strategic investment that provides stability and diversification in an increasingly uncertain economic environment. Looking ahead, the festive and wedding season in the second half is expected to support demand. While elevated prices may continue to influence buying patterns, Indian consumers have consistently demonstrated their ability to adapt," Jain said.

Meanwhile, the WGC data showed that total gold recycled in India in the April-June quarter declined by 17 per cent to 19.2 tonnes, compared to 23.1 tonnes in the same period last year.

Total gold imports in India in the second quarter of 2026 were 98.1 tonnes, down by 23 per cent compared to 127.4 tonnes recorded in the corresponding period of 2025.

The average gold price in the second quarter was \$4,506.3 an ounce in comparison to \$3,280.4 in the corresponding period of 2025.

Tata Steel Q1 net profit jumps 19.% to ₹2,385 crore

NEW DELHI: Tata Steel on Thursday reported a 19 per cent rise in consolidated net profit to Rs 2,385.24 crore in Q1 FY27 on account of growth in revenues from India operations.

It had clocked a net profit of Rs 2,007.36 crore in Q1 FY26, the company said in an exchange filing.

Tata Steel said its total income rose to Rs 61,026.97

crore from Rs 53,466.79 crore in the same quarter a year ago.

The board also approved the core project of steelmaking capacity expansion by 4.8 MTPA in NINL for an estimated capex of Rs 33,873 crore. This will enable Tata Steel to further expand its long products portfolio, especially in the retail space where the company's branded products are in high demand. PTI

NSE consolidated net Q1 profit rises 7% to ₹3,120 cr, total income up 9% to ₹5,252 cr

NEW DELHI: National Stock Exchange of India (NSE) on Thursday reported a 7 per cent rise in its consolidated PAT to Rs 3,120 crore for the June quarter, driven by higher operating income.

The IPO-bound exchange earned a PAT of Rs 2,924 crore in the corresponding quarter of FY26.

Its total income increased 9 per cent year-on-year to Rs 5,252 crore in the April-June

quarter of FY27 from Rs 4,798 crore a year ago, the bourse said in a statement.

Its revenue from transaction charges, the exchange's largest income source, rose to Rs 3,623 crore during the quarter from Rs 3,154 crore in the year-ago period.

Further, revenue from data connectivity charges stood at Rs 258 crore, while operating investment income came in at Rs 234 crore. Revenue from

data feed and terminal services was Rs 150 crore.

On the expenditure front, total expenses increased to Rs 1,129 crore in the first quarter of FY27 from Rs 1,053 crore in the corresponding period of the previous fiscal.

During the quarter, NSE contributed Rs 20,579 crore to the exchequer, including collections and payments.

This comprised Securities Transaction Tax/Commodities

Transaction Tax (STT/CTT) of Rs 18,313 crore, stamp duty of Rs 980 crore, GST of Rs 657 crore, income tax of Rs 373 crore and Sebi fees of Rs 256 crore.

Of the total STT/CTT collections, the equity derivatives segment accounted for 57 per cent, followed by the cash market delivery-based segment at 37 per cent and the cash market intraday segment at 6 per cent. MPOST

Hyundai Motor Q1 PAT down 35% at ₹888.62 cr

NEW DELHI: Hyundai Motor India Ltd (HMIL) on Thursday reported a 35 per cent decline in consolidated profit after tax to Rs 888.62 crore in the first quarter ended June 30, impacted by lower revenue and higher expenses.

The company had posted a consolidated PAT of Rs 1,369.23 crore in the corresponding period of the pre-

vious fiscal year, HMIL said in a regulatory filing.

Consolidated revenue from operations stood at Rs 16,334.63 crore as against Rs 16,412.88 crore in the year-ago period, it added.

Total expenses were higher at Rs 15,407.35 crore as compared to Rs 14,780.47 crore in the corresponding period of the previous fiscal year, HMIL said. PTI

Sport

Landing among the best

After overcoming serious injury, Sreeshankar soars to second straight CWG medal

S KANNAN

GLASGOW: Murali Sreeshankar warmed the hearts of Indian athletics fans on a chilly Wednesday night, soaring to 8.09 metres to claim the Commonwealth Games long jump silver medal.

Written off by many after a career-threatening knee injury ruled him out of the Paris 2024 Olympics, Sreeshankar scripted a stirring comeback built on resilience, self-belief and unwavering determination. Behind the smile was the pain of a long rehabilitation and the desire to prove his doubters wrong.

The 27-year-old, affectionately known as 'Sree', was a picture of focus throughout the competition. Before every attempt, he meticulously rehearsed his run-up, repeating the same routine with remarkable precision. It was not mere repetition but a carefully choreographed ritual that culminated in his best jump of 8.09m.

The conditions were far from ideal. With temperatures dipping and a biting wind sweeping across the arena, Sreeshankar—who hails from the warm climate of Kerala's Palakkad district—kept himself wrapped up in a monkey cap between jumps to stay



Murali Sreeshankar produced a jump of 8.09 metres to win the silver medal

AP

warm. Yet he refused to let the weather become an excuse.

Once the silver was secured, an emotional Sreeshankar embraced his father and coach, S. Murali, in the stands. The moment symbolised years of sacrifice and perseverance. With support from the Indian Olympic Association, Murali had travelled to Glasgow to coach his son,

and together they celebrated another Commonwealth silver after Birmingham 2022.

"This feels special, actually. Probably I would cherish this for one or two days, and then I have to get back to work. But this silver medal really means a lot to me. For everyone who supported me during the tough times, and everyone who said

that I won't be jumping again in my career, this medal is for you," Sreeshankar said.

He thanked God, his supporters and the country while making it clear that his journey is far from over.

"I am thankful to everyone who supported me, thankful to my country. A better performance has to follow. I have to really up my game for the Asian

1
He became the first Indian long-jumper to win two successive medals at the Commonwealth Games

Games to win a medal for my country," he added.

Sreeshankar also underlined the importance of adapting to difficult conditions.

"Obviously, the conditions were cold and windy, but it is applicable to everyone. You can't blame the weather. You have to adapt to the conditions and gain an edge over your fellow competitors. That's what I did."

He also credited fellow Indian athletes for helping him adjust to the unfamiliar weather. "To be very honest, I'm really happy with how the athletes are helping me. I was talking to Sarvesh and TJ (Tejaswin Shankar) over dinner about how to cope with the cold since we're used to India's heat. All those inputs helped."

'India peaking at right time': PT Usha happy with CWG display

S KANNAN

GLASGOW: India's para-athletes remained an inspiring and unstoppable force at the Commonwealth Games as sprinters Dilip Mahadu Gavit and Mohammed Basil scripted another story of grit with a gold-silver finish in the men's 100m T47 final here.

Gavit clocked a Games record and his season's best time of 10.71 seconds to take

the top spot, while Basil produced his season's best of 10.83 seconds to finish second in a closely-fought race on Wednesday. England's Kevin Santos completed the podium taking 10.85 seconds to win bronze. The men's 100m T47 is a para athletics sprint event covers arm impairment or absence, affecting strength, movement or coordination on one side.

Gavit's gold was India's third at the Games, following Mirabai Chanu's victory in the women's 48kg weightlifting event and Sharmila Dhankar's triumph in the women's shot put F57 para athletics category. The 40-year-old Sharmila, who was afflicted with Polio at two years of age, survived the trauma of an abusive marriage to come this far. AGENCIES

GLASGOW: Indian Olympic Association president PT Usha is pleased that the performance of the Indian athletes at the Commonwealth Games in Glasgow is peaking. In a chat with Millennium Post on Thursday, Usha said the medals won and more loading are a very positive sign. As things stand, India will eventually finish with a medal tally of over

25, though what is officially recorded now is 15.

Usha said the performance from most disciplines is an encouraging sign. "This time, Glasgow organisers had to cut the disciplines to 10. Yet, what gives me happiness is the athletes have done well, both Able Bodied as well as the Para athletes. It is also very encouraging that even the British media is praising our efforts," said the IOA President.



India has won 61 medals at the last Commonwealth Games in Birmingham in 2022. This time, the medal tally has to be lower. But the way medals have been won even in track

and field is a revelation. "We won a medal through Gulveer in 10,000 metres, we won a medal through Sarvesh Kushare in high jump and Murali Sreeshankar won in long jump. All this is very encouraging for me and India," said a happy Usha.

Travelling from one venue to another in Glasgow, be it athletics, boxing and weightlifting, Usha has been in touch with all the athletes. "The sup-

port which is being provided to the athletes is massive. All the stakeholders are on the same page, from the Sports Ministry to SAI and the IOA. Personally, I will mention, the medical support system comprising a team, led by Dr Dinshaw Pardiwala and the physios are backing up the athletes well. In the IOA, we have also helped bring the personal coaches of Neeraj Chopra and Sreeshankar," stressed Dr Usha.



ग्रेटर नौएडा औद्योगिक विकास प्राधिकरण
प्लॉट संख्या-1, नोलेज पार्क-IV, ग्रेटर नौएडा सिटी, गौतमबुद्ध नगर-201308, उ.प्र., वेबसाइट: www.greaternoidaauthority.in, ईमेल: authority@gnida.in

पत्रांक: वरि०.प्र०/(ई-निविदा सेल)/2026/6763 दिनांक: 30.07.2026

आर.एफ.पी./ई-निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना

वरिष्ठ प्रबंधक (वर्क सर्किल-3) ग्रेटर नौएडा औद्योगिक विकास प्राधिकरण द्वारा मुख्य कार्यपालक अधिकारी, ग्रेटर नौएडा की ओर से ई-निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना संख्या-वरि०. प्र. निविदा सेल/2026/6762 दिनांक-30.07.2026 के माध्यम से उल्लेखित क्रम संख्या-01 पर अंकित कार्य की ई-निविदा आमंत्रित की जाती है। ई-निविदा की समस्त नियम व शर्तें ग्रेटर नौएडा प्राधिकरण की वेबसाइट: www.greaternoidaauthority.in पर ई-निविदा लिंक एवं ई-पोर्टल <http://etender.up.nic.in> पर उपलब्ध है। किसी परिवर्तन, संशोधन व अतिरिक्त सूचनाओं के लिए उक्त वेबसाइट देखते रहें।

क्र. सं.	कार्य का नाम/वर्क सर्किल	अनुमानित लागत
1.	Design Engineering, Development of Waste to Wonder Park (Adbut Bharat Park) on Revenue Share Model for 20 years at D-park Greater Noida.	रु० 17.06 करोड़

क्रम सं. 01 पर अंकित दिनांक 31.07.2026 से 21.08.2026 को 17:00 बजे तक अपलोड किया जा सकता है, एवं प्राचा ई-निविदाओं की प्री-क्वालिफिकेशन दिनांक 24.07.2026 को 11:00 बजे खोली जायेगी।

वरिष्ठ प्रबंधक (वर्क सर्किल-3)

Follow Us On  / OfficialGNIDA

NORTHERN RAILWAY
OPEN E-TENDER NOTICE
No. 128-W/280/e Tender Notice/NIT/34/2026-27/W-3 Dated :- 29.07.2026
The Sr. Divisional Engineer-III, Northern Railway, Delhi Division invites E-Tender for the following work.

1	Name of work	Repair and Renovation of existing old corroded metal color coated sheets valley gutters and associated coping works from PF No 16 to PF NO- 01 along with allied civil and finishing works for station building and PF at New Delhi Railway station and repair and renovation works of ladies, gents toilets at the holding area, first floor toilet of the station building including plumbing, sanitary, tiling and other allied civil and maintenance works at New Delhi railway station in the section of SSE/W/NDLS/Str under ADEN/NDLS.
2	Approx cost of work	Rs. 3,63,59,394.52/- (Rupees Three Crore Sixty Three Lakh Fifty Nine Thousand Three Hundred Ninety Four and Fifty Two Paise only)
3	Earnest Money to be deposited	Rs. 7,27,200.00- (Rupees Seven Lakh Twenty Seven Thousand Two Hundred Only)
4	Cost of tender document	Rs. 0.00/-
5	Date & Time of submission of tender bid and opening of tender	20.08.2026 @ 15:00 Hrs.
6	Website particulars where complete details of tender documents can be seen	www.ireps.gov.in

* The tenderer/s must be registered on the Indian Railway E-Procurement system (IREPS) site i.e. www.ireps.gov.in for participating in the e-tender system. • For all terms and conditions please refer tender document. • No manual offers are acceptable. • Cost of tender document and Earnest money will be acceptable through net banking or payment gateway only. 2629/26

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Sanjay @ Aryan, S/o: Vasudev, R/o: H.No. C-53, Janta Jeevan Camp, Okhla Industrial Area-II, New Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 306/2019, U/s 324/34/34 IPC, P.S.: Okhla Industrial Area, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Sanjay @ Aryan** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Sanjay @ Aryan** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Sanjay @ Aryan** accused of offence in case **FIR No. 306/2019, U/s 324/34/34 IPC, P.S.: Okhla Industrial Area, Delhi** and is required to appear beforethis Court to answer the said complaint on or before **31.08.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Akansha Gautam
Judicial Magistrate First Class-02
Room No. 513
Saket Court Complex, New Delhi

DP/10576/SE/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED
See Section 82 Cr. P.C. / 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Sushil Kumar Prop. of M/s Jyoti Electronics & Furniture, at E-6, Pratap Garden, Main Bindapur, Uttam Nagar, New Delhi** has Committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **CC No. 4238/2022 U/s 138 NI Act, P.S. Kirti Nagar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Sushil Kumar** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Sushil Kumar** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Sushil Kumar** of case **CC No. 4238/2022 U/s 138 NI Act, P.S. Kirti Nagar, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **15.09.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Anshul Singhal
Judicial Magistrate First Class-04
West, Room No. 268
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/9691/WD/2026 (Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED
See Section 82 Cr. P.C. / 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Sehnawaj S/o Lt. Maqsud R/o Jhuggi No. G-16, JJ Colony, Bawana, Delhi** has Committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 506/2019 U/s 33 Delhi Excise Act, P.S. Narela Industrial Area, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Sehnawaj** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Sehnawaj** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Sehnawaj** of case **FIR No. 506/2019 U/s 33 Delhi Excise Act, P.S. Narela Industrial Area, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **14.09.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Jyoti Nain
Judicial Magistrate First Class-07
North District, Room No. 6
Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/10449/ON/2026 (Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 Cr. P.C. / 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Kajal, D/o. Ashok Sehgal, R/o: A-213, DDA Flat, Top Floor, Punjabi Colony, Jahangir Puri, Delhi-110035** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in a case vide **CT. No. 3405/2018 U/S 138 NI ACT** registered at **P.S Mahindra Park, North West District, Delhi** and it has been returned on a warrant of arrest there upon issued stating that the said **Kajal** could not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that accused **Kajal** is absconded (or is concealing herself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Kajal**, accused of **CT. No. 3405/2018 U/S 138 NI ACT, P.S Mahindra Park, North West District, Delhi** is required to appear before the court to answer the said complaint on or before **01.09.2026 at 10.00 A.M.**

By Order, Ms. Amardeep Kaur,
Addl. Chief Judicial Magistrate (North),
Room No.117, Rohini Courts, Delhi.

DP/10564/NW/2026
(Court Matter)

Office of the Executive Engineer
Road Construction Department,
Road Division, Garhwa.

e-Procurement Notice
For National Competitive Bidding
e-Tender Reference No. : RCD/GARHWA/688/2026-27
Date:- 29.07.2026

1.	Name of the work	Construction of H.L.L. bridge over Birha River at 14th km of Bhandaria-Bargarh-Tehri road for the year of 2026-27 under R.C.D. Road Division, Garhwa
2a.	Approximate Value of Work	Rs. 4,09,01,975.00 (Rupees Four crore Nine Lac One thousand Nine hundred Seventy Five) only.
b.	Bid Security*	Rs. 41,00,000.00 (Rupees Forty One Lac) only.
3.	Time of Completion	18 (Eighteen) Months.
4.	Date of Publication of Tender on website	07-08-2026, 10.30 A.M.
5.	Last date of Tender for receipt of bids	24-08-2026, 12.00 Noon
6.	Name & address of office Inviting tender	Executive Engineer, RCD, Road Division, Garhwa Pin Code - 822114
7.	Contact no. of Procurement officer	06561-295161
8.	Helpline number of e-Procurement cell	0651-2401010

Note:- The Bid Amount & Bid security will be decrease or increase. Further details can be seen on website <http://jharkhandtenders.gov.in> U/CAN registration is mandatory for the bidders who are already registered in appropriate class with road construction department Govt. of Jharkhand.

Executive Engineer,
Road Construction Department,
Road Division, Garhwa.

PR 386303 Road(26-27).D

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 CrPC / 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Vijay @ Monu S/o Dharam Pal, R/o H.No. 686/2D, Gali No.-3, Punjabi Basti, Military Road, Anand Parbat, New Delhi**, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 72/2015, U/S 324/34 IPC, PS Anand Parbat, Central Distt., Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Vijay @ Monu** cannot be found, and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Vijay @ Monu** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant);

Proclamation is hereby made that **Vijay @ Monu** the said accused of **FIR No. 72/2015, U/S 324/34 IPC, PS Anand Parbat, Central Distt., Delhi**, is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **31.08.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Vijay Shankar
Additional Sessions Judge-04 (West)
Room No.-202, 2nd Floor,
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/10564/CD/2026
(Court Matter)

**UNION TERRITORY OF JAMMU & KASHMIR**
OFFICE OF THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER PWD (R&B) DIVISION GANDHI NAGAR JAMMU
SHORT NOTICE INVITING TENDER

Short e-NIT No. DGN/50of 2026-27 Dated 29-07-2026
For and on behalf of the Lieutenant Governor, Union Territory of Jammu and Kashmir-tenders are invited on percentage basis from approved and eligible Contractors registered with Union Territory of J&K, CPWD, Railways, MES and other State/Central Governments for each of the following works :-

S. No.	Name of Work	Name of Division	Advertised Cost (Rs. Lakh)	Cost of document (in Rs.)	Earnest Money (in Rs.)	Time Allowed for completion	Time and date of opening of tender	Class of Contractor
1	Up-gradation cum Renovation of Paryavaran Bhawan Building at Gladini Narwal, Jammu (Under M.H.-Capex Budget 2026-27)	PWD (R&B) Division Gandhi Nagar	24.24	600	48480 (2% of the Advertised Cost)	03 Months	(1200 Hrs) on or after 10-08-2026	"A", "B" & "C" Class
2	Construction of Boundary Wall at SDRF 2nd Bn. from Main Gate adjacent to Police Family Quarters, Gulshan Ground Gandhi Nagar Jammu (Under M.H.-Capex Budget 2026-27)	PWD (R&B) Division Gandhi Nagar	23.39	600	46780 (2% of the Advertised Cost)	02 Months	(1200 Hrs) on or after 10-08-2026	"A", "B" & "C" Class
3	Filling of Parking Area and other allied works at Forensic Science Laboratory, Birkram Chowk, Jammu (Under M.H.-4055)	PWD (R&B) Division Gandhi Nagar	10.17	600	20340 (2% of the Advertised Cost)	02 Months	(1200 Hrs) on or after 10-08-2026	"A", "B" & "C" & "D" Class

Position of AAA:- **Accorded byIFS/PCCF Director vide order No. 54-DEERS of 2026 dated 06-07-2026 amounting to ` 24.96 Lacs for item No. 1, Commandant General HG, CD and SDRF Jammu/Srinagar vide order No. 406 of 2026 dated 20-07-2026 amounting to ` 24.09 Lacs for item No. 2 and Director Forensic Science Laboratory J&K Jammu/Srinagar vide order No. 110 of 2026 dated 07-07-2026 amounting to ` 10.50 Lacs for item No. 3.**

Position of TS:- **Sanctioned bythis office vide order No. 45/PWD Div. Gandhi Nagar/2026-27 dated 21-07-2026 amounting to ` 24.24 Lacs for item No. 1, order No. 54/PWD Div. Gandhi Nagar/2026-27 dated 25-07-2026 amounting to ` 23.39 Lacs for item No. 2 and order No. 46/PWD Div. Gandhi Nagar/2026-27 dated 21-07-2026 amounting to ` 10.17 Lacs for item No. 3.**

Project Authority:- **IFS/PCCF Director for item No. 1, Commandant General HG, CD and SDRF Jammu/Srinagar for item No. 2 and Director Forensic Science Laboratory J&K Jammu/Srinagar for item No. 3.**

Major Head of Account:- **Under Capex Budget 2026-27 UT Sector for item No. 1, M.H.-Capex Budget 2026-27 for item No. 2 and M.H-4055 for item No. 3.**

The Bidding documents Consisting of qualifying information, eligibility criteria, specifications, Drawings, bill of quantities (B.O.Q), Set of terms and conditions of contract and other details can be seen/downloaded from the departmental website <http://jktenders.gov.in> as per below schedule :

1	Date of Issue of Tender Notice	29-07-2026
2	Period of downloading of bidding documents	From 29-07-2026 to 08-08-2026, 1800 Hrs
3	Date, Time and place of pre-bid meeting	01-08-2026 at 1300 Hrs. in the Office of Executive Engineer PWD (R&B) Division Gandhi Nagar Jammu
4	Bid submission Start Date	29-07-2026
5	Bid Submission End Date	08-08-2026 upto 1800 Hrs
6	Date & time of opening of Technical Bids (Online)	10-08-2026 on or after 1200 Hrs in the Office of Executive Engineer PWD (R&B) Division Gandhi Nagar Jammu
7	Date & time of opening of Financial Bids	To be notified after technical bid evaluation is completed

1.Bids must be accompanied with cost of Tender document in shape of e-challan through Treasury indicating Treasury Voucher No. & date, e-NIT No. and name of work duly crediting to 0059 (Revenue) favoring Office of Executive Engineer PWD (R&B) Division Gandhi Nagar Jammu and upload the same Le treasury challan/ receipt, Earnest money/Bid security in shape of CDR/FDR/BG pledged to Office of Executive Engineer PWD (R&B) Division Gandhi Nagar Jammu. The CDR/ FDR/BG shall be valid for 45 Days beyond the bid validity period. The original instruments in respect of cost of documents, EMD and relevant documents of L1/ be submitted to the Office of Executive Engineer PWD (R&B) Division Gandhi Nagar Jammu at the time of allotment.

2.The electronic bidding system would not allow any late submission of bids after due date and time as per server time. Bidders may modify their bids by uploading their request for modification before the deadline for submission of bids. For this, the bidder need not to make any additional payment towards the cost of tender document. For bid modification and consequential re-submission, the bidder is not required to withdraw his bid submitted earlier. The last modified bid submitted by the bidder within the bid submission time shall be considered as the bid. For this purpose, modification/withdrawal by other means will not be accepted. In online system of bid submission, the modification and consequential- submission of bids is allowed any number of times. The bidders may withdraw his bid by uploading their request before the deadline for submission of bids; however, if the bid is withdrawn, the re-submission of the bid is not allowed. No bid shall be modified or withdrawn after the deadline of submission of bids.

3.The date and time of opening of Financial-Bids shall be notified on Web Site www.jktenders.gov.in conveyed to the bidders automatically through an e-mail message on their e-mail address. The Financial-bids of responsive bidders shall be opened online in the Office of Executive Engineer PWD (R&B) Division Gandhi Nagar Jammu. The date for same shall be intimated separately.

4.The bids for the work shall remain valid for a period of 120 days from the date of opening of Technical bids.

Sd/- (Er. Karanjeet Singh)
Executive Engineer
PWD (R&B) Division Gandhi Nagar

DIP No.DIP/1-6965/26

**Bandhan Bank**

Regional Office: Netaji Marg, Nr. Mithakhali Six Roads, Ellisbridge, Ahmedabad-6. Phone: + 91-79-26421671-75

Demand Notice to Borrowers

The under mentioned account turned into N.P.A and demand notice is issued by Bandhan Bank Ltd. to the following borrower(s), under sec.13(2) of the Securitization and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act (The Act), 2002 which was returned unserved. Hence, this notice is issued to you all and public at large through publication.

Name of borrower(s), and Loan Account No.	Description of mortgaged property (Secured Asset)	Date of Demand Notice/Date of NPA	Q/S Amount as on Date of Demand Notice	Date of Pasting of Notice
Mr. Girraj Kumar S/O Jagvir Mrs. Rashmi 7118000007077	All The Piece and Parcel of Residential House Situated At Village Tugalpur, Pargana-Dankour, Teh And Distt-Gautam Buddha Nagar One Storey No-2, Street No-3, West Facing, Whose Measurement Is 18 Feet 3 Inch In East And 18 Feet 3 Inch In West Side, 39 Feet On The North Side Thus The Total Area Is 79.08 Sq Yard I.E. 66.12 Sq Mtr. Owned By Girraj Kumar S/O Jagvir and Same Bounded as Under: North: House Kamlesh, East: Road Gali 10 Feet Wide, West: House Patram, South: House Of Shahi	October 31, 2025/ March 31, 2025	Rs.7,92,650.76	July 24, 2026
Mr. Radhey Gopal S/O Chandra Kumar Bajpai Mr. Shiv Gopal S/O Chandra Kumar Bajpai 7019000005124	All That Part and Parcel of SF-2, Plot No. 17, Kharsa No. 266, Village- Bisloli, Tehsil-Dadri, District-G. B Nagar, Uttar Pradesh-203207 Owned by Sh. Radhey Gopal S/O Chandra Kumar Bajpai and Same Bounded as Under: North: Flat No. SF-1 & SF-3, East: Road 18 Feet Wide, West: Other Plot, South: Other Plot	September 20, 2025/ March 31, 2025	Rs.9,15,053.79	July 24, 2026
Mr. Satish Kumar Jain S/O Inder Sen Jain Mrs. Shahu Gupta W/O Mr. Satish Kumar Jain 7019000004976	All That Part and Parcel of Built-Up Property Bearing No. RZ-80, Land Area Measuring 55 Sq. Yds. Out of Kharsa No. 348 & 351 Situated in Revenue Estate of Village-Nisarpur, Colony-West Sagarpur, New Delhi-11046 Owned by Mr. Satish Kumar Jain S/O Mr. Inder Sen Jain and Same Bounded as Under: North: Road 20 Ft, East: Other's Property, West: Other's Property, South: Other's Property	September 20, 2025/ March 03, 2025	Rs.8,80,999.68	July 24, 2026

Demand made against you through this notice to repay to the Bank dues mentioned against your name with interest, costs and charges within 60 days from the date hereof, failing which the Bank will further proceed to take steps u/s.13(4) of the SARFAESI Act. The borrowers'/mortgagors' attention is invited to the provisions of sub-section (8) of section 13 of the Act, in respect of time available, to redeem the secured assets.

Place: Uttar Pradesh
Date: July 31, 2026

Authorised Officer
Bandhan Bank Limited

APPENDIX IV-A
Salae Notice for sale of Immovable Property

E-Auction Sale Notice for sale of Immovable Assets under the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 read with proviso to Rule 8(6) and Rule 9(1) of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002.

Notice is hereby given to the public in general and in particular to the Borrower(s) and Guarantor(s) that the below described Immovable Property mortgaged to **Sammaan Capital Limited (formerly known as Indiabulls Housing Finance Ltd.) [CIN : L65922DL2005PLC136029] ("Secured Creditor")**, the physical possession of which has been taken by the Authorised Officer of the Secured Creditor, will be sold on "as is where is", "as is what is" and "whatever there is" basis on **20.08.2026 from 05.00 P.M. to 06.00 P.M.**, for recovery of **Rs. 23,79,779/- (Rupees Twenty Three Lakh Seventy Nine Thousand Seven Hundred Seventy Nine only)** pending towards **Loan Account No. HHLND00416572**, by way of outstanding principal, arrears (including accrued late charges) and interest till **21.07.2026** with applicable future interest in terms of the Loan Agreement and other related loan document(s) w. e. f. **22.07.2026** along with legal expenses and other charges due to the Secured Creditor from **GAURAV KUMAR, ASHISH and KIRAN KUMARI**.

The Reserve Price of the Immoveable Property will be **Rs. 14,51,000/- (Rupees Fourteen Lakh Fifty One Thousand only)** and the Earnest Money Deposit ("EMD") will be **Rs. 1,45,100/- (Rupees One Lakh Forty Five Thousand One Hundred only)** i.e. equivalent to 10% of the Reserve Price.

DESCRIPTION OF THE IMMOVABLE PROPERTY

RESIDENTIAL FLAT NO. - SF - 1, M. I. G. TYPE, SECOND FLOOR, (WITH ROOF RIGHTS), LEFT HAND FRONT SIDE, HAVING ITS TOTAL AND COVERED AREA MEASURING 550 SQ. FEET, I. E. 51.09 SQ. METRES, BUILT ON PLOT NO. C - 1/58, SITUATED AT DLF ANKUR VIHAR, VILLAGE SADULLABAD / LONI, PARGANA AND TEHSIL LONI, DISTRICT GHAZIABAD - 201010, UTTAR PRADESH.

For detailed terms and conditions of sale, please refer to the link provided on the website of the Secured Creditor i.e. www.sammaancapital.com; Contact No : 0124-6910910, +91 7065451024; E-mail id : auctionhelpline@sammaancapital.com. For bidding, log on to www.auctionfocus.in.

sdl/-
AUTHORIZED OFFICER
SAMMAAN CAPITAL LIMITED
(Formerly known as
INDIABULLS HOUSING FINANCE LTD.)

Date : 27.07.2026
Place : GHAZIABAD

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 CrPC / 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Amir S/o Shokin, R/o H.No. 164, 1st Floor, Khanna Nagar, Loni, Ghaziabad (U.P.)**, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 127/26, U/S 25 Arms Act & 113/61(2) Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, 2023, PS Special Cell, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Amir** cannot be found, and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Amir** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant);

Proclamation is hereby made that **Amir** the said accused of **FIR No. 127/26, U/S 25 Arms Act & 113/61(2) Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, 2023, PS Special Cell, Delhi**, is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **15.10.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Siddhant Sihag
Additional Chief Judicial Magistrate -02
Court No.-07, Main Building,
DP/10356/Spl. Cell/2026
(Court Matter)
Patiala House Court, New Delhi

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
(See Section 82 Cr. P.C./84 BNSS)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused **Rohit S/o Ombir @Bhure R/o Gali No. 11, main Gopal Nagar, Najafgarh, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **CC/FIR No. 64/2019 U/s 379/411/511/34 IPC & 25 ARMS ACT, PS Mundka, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said accused **Rohit** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Rohit** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that **Rohit** in **CC/ FIR No. 64/2019 U/s 379/411/511/34 IPC & 25 ARMS ACT, PS Mundka, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **01.09.2026**.

By order
Sh. Gaurav Singal
Judicial Magistrate First Class-06
West, Room No. 355
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/10525/OD/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
(See Section 82 Cr.PC)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Sunny Pawar, S/o Sharwan Pawar R/o H.No.780, Rishi Nagar, Rani Bagh, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No.352/2024 u/s 279/337 IPC, P.S. Paschim Vihar East, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Sunny Pawar** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Sunny Pawar** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Sunny Pawar** of **FIR No.352/2024 u/s 279/337 IPC, P.S. Paschim Vihar East, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **02.09.2026**.

By Order,
Moksha Bains
Judicial Magistrate First Class-11 (West)
Room No.31, Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/10499/OD/2026

**NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY**

Tender Notice No. : JHS-N-GSU-14-26 Dated : 22.07.2026

E-Tendering Tender Notice

Dy. Chief Signal & Telecom Engineer/GSU/Jhansi, DRM's office, Jhansi, for and on behalf of President of India invites open Tender through on Line (E-Tendering) for the following works:-

E-Tender No. : JHS-N-GSU-14-26	Approx Cost : Rs. 11967321.88
Description of work : EI alteration and other S&T work in connection with provision for extension of A&D siding for full length shunting neck & conversion of ballast siding to full length goods line at Chirgaon station of Jhansi division.	
Earnest Money : Rs. 239400.00	Cost of Tender Form : Nil.
Opening of tender : 14.08.2026 Time : 15:00	
Completion period from issue of letter of acceptance : 12 Months	

* Tender on line can be submitted upto **15:00 hrs on 14.08.2026**. • For full details and submission of bid please see the Indian Railways website www.ireps.gov.in (JHANSI DIVISION-GATI SHAKTI, NORTH CENTRAL RLY). 1733/26 (C)

 North central railways  www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in  @CPRNCR

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 Cr.P.C./ 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Ankush, S/o: Surender Grovar, R/o: Mangal Bazar Road, Karan Gupta Store Ke Samne Wali Gali No-3, Agar Nagar Prem Nagar-III, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No.: 184/2023, U/s: 25/54/59 Arms ACT, P.S. Prem Nagar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Ankush** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Ankush** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Ankush** of **P.S. Prem Nagar, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **31.08.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Shagun
JMFC-07, North West Distt., Room No. 109,
Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/10476/RD/2026



‘WASN’T SURPRISED BY AMAZON’S EXIT FROM ARTIFICIAL’

Andrew Garfield is grateful that Luca Guadagnino’s new movie has found ‘the home that it was meant to find’

Andrew Garfield is grateful that ‘Artificial’, filmmaker Luca Guadagnino’s new movie about OpenAI chief Sam Altman, has found ‘the home that it was meant to find’ after being dropped by Amazon MGM Studios.

Independent distributor ‘Neon’ recently acquired the global rights to the nearly completed film, weeks after ‘Amazon MGM Studios’ exited the project, saying it believed the movie would be ‘better served if it were released by a different studio’.

“I was and I wasn’t surprised. I think there are certain things that fit in certain places and don’t fit in other places and they (Amazon) were nothing but supportive and nothing but encouraging while we were making the film. Luca has a really great relationship with them and I’ve developed a lovely relationship with them as well. I’m grateful that they’ve helped the film to find the home that it was meant to find,” Garfield told ‘Variety’ while promoting his upcoming film ‘The Magic Faraway Tree’.



‘Artificial’ chronicles the dramatic events surrounding the brief ouster and reinstatement of Sam Altman as chief executive of ‘OpenAI’ in 2023

Written by former ‘Saturday Night Live’ writer Simon Rich, ‘Artificial’ chronicles the dramatic events surrounding the brief ouster and reinstatement of Sam Altman as chief executive of ‘OpenAI’ in 2023, as the battle over the future of artificial intelligence unfolds.

Garfield, known for movies such as ‘The Social Network’,

‘The Amazing Spider-Man’ and ‘Hacksaw Ridge’, essays the role of Altman in the film.

Amazon’s decision to part ways with ‘Artificial’ came months after it entered into a major partnership with ‘OpenAI’.

Garfield said he didn’t reach out to Altman while preparing to portray the ‘OpenAI’ chief executive. “I wouldn’t know how to. I don’t have his number. I don’t have his email. But I’m sure that he’d be able to reach me if he wants to. I’d be very excited and curious to talk with him if he would ever want to do that,” he said.

The actor said there was enough publicly available material to study Altman. “He’s very, very documented. There are lots of interviews. There’s lots of visuals and audio and reporting. I, of course, would have loved and still would love to meet Sam. But I’m playing a version of the character that was written in the script,” Garfield said.

‘Artificial’ also stars Monica Barbaro, Yura Borisov, Mark Rylance, Ike Barinholtz, Jason Schwartzman, Zosia Mamet, Cooper Hoffman, Chris O’Dowd, Cooper Koch and Billie Lourd.

‘Neon’ plans to mount an awards campaign for the film in the upcoming Oscar season.

PTI

‘YOUNG SHERLOCK’ SEASON TWO

And the mystery deepens further!



‘Prime Video’ announced new series regulars joining the cast of the new season

OUR CORRESPONDENT

Prime Video announced new series regulars joining the cast of the second season of ‘Young Sherlock’ and released a start-of-production video featuring Guy Ritchie, Hero Fiennes Tiffin and Dónal Finn. The series, from visionary director Ritchie and starring Fiennes Tiffin, is an irreverent, action-packed mystery that charts the legendary origin story of the world’s greatest detective.

Joining the cast as series regulars this season are Olivia Williams, Indira Varma, Sophie Skelton and Aidan Gillen.

Olivia Williams is a highly accomplished English actress in film, television and theatre. She is mostly remembered for her role as Anna Crowe in M Night Shyamalan’s ‘The Sixth Sense’ and Rosemary Cross in Wes Anderson’s definitive film ‘Rushmore’.

Indira Varma trained at the Royal Academy of Dramatic Art (RADA). Her screen credits include ‘The Other Bennet Sister’, ‘The Capture’, ‘The Night

Joining the cast this season are Olivia Williams, Indira Varma, Sophie Skelton and Aidan Gillen

Manager’ S2 alongside Tom Hiddleston and Olivia Colman and many more.

Sophie Skelton is best known for her portrayal of Brianna Randall Fraser in the BAFTA-winning, Golden Globe and Emmy-nominated drama series ‘Outlander’.

Aidan Gillen is the recipient of three Irish Film & Television Awards and has been nominated for a British Academy Television Award, a British Independent Film Award and a Tony Award. On television, he can most recently be seen in Taylor Sheridan/‘Paramount+’ series ‘Mayor of Kingstown’ and the ‘AMC+’ series ‘Kin’.

The series cast also includes Dónal Finn, Natascha McElhone, Holly Cattle and Max Irons.

BBC’S ‘JARED LETO: HOLLYWOOD’S DARK SECRET’

Jared Leto denies sexual assault allegations

Four women have accused Jared Leto of sexual misconduct when they were teenagers, to which the actor and musician responded that he has ‘never sexually assaulted anyone’.

“I have never sexually assaulted anyone in my entire life. These claims are absolutely and categorically false,” Leto, 54, said in a statement to ‘The Associated Press’ on Wednesday.

The BBC documentary ‘Jared Leto: Hollywood’s Dark Secret’, released on July 29, details allegations including those from four women who accused the actor of sexual misconduct and assault between 2002 and 2016, when they were teenagers and Leto was an adult.

One said she was 17 when she was sexually assaulted, while another accused Leto of statutory rape as she was also 17. One woman said she was 19 when Leto threatened her with sexual assault and another said she was 16 when



Leto made sexually explicit phone calls and propositioned her.

The BBC said it corroborated the women’s accounts, which could not be independently verified by the AP. The documentary does not identify the women by their full names.

‘These claims are absolutely and categorically false,’ says the actor on the BBC documentary

tify the women by their full names.

The BBC said Leto didn’t respond to its attempts to seek comments for its documentary. The AP sent an emailed request for comment to the BBC on Wednesday seeking a response to Leto’s denial.

Leto was also accused of misconduct by nine women who spoke to ‘Air Mail’ for a story published last year. A representative for Leto denied those allegations at the time.

Leto, an Oscar winner for his supporting role in ‘Dallas Buyers Club’, is also the frontman of the band ‘Thirty Seconds to Mars’. He recently starred as Skeletor in ‘Masters of the Universe’.

AGENCIES

Salim Khan chosen for Late Raj Kapoor Lifetime Achievement Award

Rani Mukerji will also be felicitated at the ceremony

The Maharashtra government announced the Chitrapati V Shantaram Lifetime Achievement Award for veteran musician Pandit Hridaynath Mangeshkar, while screenwriter Salim Khan has been chosen for the Late Raj Kapoor Lifetime Achievement Award.

Actor and director Prasad Oak has been selected for the Chitrapati V Shantaram Special Contribution Award. At the same time, acclaimed actress Rani Mukerji has been chosen for the Late Raj Kapoor Special Contribution Award, said Cultural Affairs Minister Ashish Shelar.

These prestigious awards are presented to eminent personalities who have made outstanding and long-standing



These awards are presented to those who have made long-standing contributions to enrich Marathi and Hindi cinema

ing contributions to enrich Marathi and Hindi cinema through their work in acting, music, production, direction

and various other fields of filmmaking.

A government resolution was also issued in this regard.

PTI

‘RAMAYANA: PART 1’ TRAILER



THE BATTLE BETWEEN GOOD AND EVIL

Ranbir Kapoor’s Ram and Yash’s Ravana prepare for an epic battle

The trailer of ‘Ramayana’, touted to be one of the most expensive productions to come out of India, was released on Thursday with the promise of a theatrical extravaganza that will combine cutting-edge special effects with the age-old story of the war between good and evil.

The four-minute trailer opens with Ravana, played by south superstar Yash, before moving on to Ram, portrayed by Ranbir Kapoor in his most ambitious role yet.

Made on a reported budget of Rs 4,000 crore, the two-part saga is directed by Nitesh Tiwari of ‘Dangal’ fame and has been produced by Namit Malhotra’s Prime Focus Studios’ and eight-time Academy Award-winning VFX studio DNEG, in association with actor Yash’s ‘Monster Mind Creations’.

The trailer opens with Yash’s Ravana fighting his way to become one of the most powerful kings on Earth before cutting to Dashrath, the king



of Ayodhya.

Ranbir’s Ram enters the frame as a blindfolded archer practising his target. He is announced as the next king and wins Sita’s (Sai Pallavi) hand in a ‘swyamvar’, but the celebrations take a turn when his stepmother Kaikeyi (Lara Dutta) demands that he be exiled for 14 years.

The trailer then cuts to Ram, Lakshman (Ravie Dubey) and Sita’s years in exile as they encounter all kinds of monsters and have a run-in with Suparnakha, Ravana’s sister, who is played by Rakul Preet Singh.

After her fight with Lakshman, Ravana promises to avenge her by kidnapping Sita. The

trailer ends with Ram declaring that he will defeat Ravana and bring back his wife.

Sunny Deol plays Hanuman, but he is not shown in the trailer. He will probably make an appearance either at the end of the first part or in the second part of the movie.

‘Ramayana: Part One’ will release worldwide on Diwali 2026, with global distribution by ‘Sony Pictures’ and North India distribution by ‘Dharma Productions’.

The other cast in the movie includes Ajinkya Deo in the role of sage Vishwamitra and Kunal Kapoor as lord Indra.

The movie is written by Shridhar Raghavan, who is known for hits such as ‘Pathaan’, ‘War’ and ‘The Night Man-ager’.

The trailer was released with the promise of a theatrical extravaganza that will combine cutting-edge special effects with the age-old story of the war between good and evil

music is composed by Oscar-winning music composers A R Rahman and Hans Zimmer, known for their work on Hollywood blockbusters such as ‘The Lion King’, ‘The Dark Knight Trilogy’, ‘Inception’, ‘Dunkirk’, ‘Interstellar’ and the ‘Dune’ series.

“The ‘Ramayana’ is not just one of our greatest epics; it is part of how we live, celebrate and pass on our values from one generation to the next. Every year, Dussehra and Diwali remind us that its message continues to guide millions through the triumph of light over darkness and righteousness over evil. Very few stories continue to shape everyday life thousands of years after they were first told. The ‘Rama-

yana’ does,” Malhotra said.

Malhotra said he always believed that India’s greatest stories deserve to be experienced on the world’s biggest stage. “Today, we finally have the artists, the technology, the craftsmanship and the collective ambition to present this extraordinary cultural legacy to audiences everywhere with the authenticity, scale and cinematic excellence it deserves. This is not simply the beginning of a film. It is the beginning of a journey to celebrate India’s cultural richness with the world. India has always lived this story. It is now our privilege to share it with the world.”

Tiwari said that as a director his responsibility was to approach the story with complete honesty. He said it was a privilege of a lifetime to work alongside some of the world’s finest artists, technicians and storytellers on the movie.

“The Ramayana is one of the greatest stories ever told, not because of its scale, but because of the timeless values it represents. As a filmmaker, I never felt the responsibility to make it universal; it already is. My responsibility has been to approach it with complete honesty, authenticity and reverence. Every creative decision we have made - from the writing and performances to the production design, music, visual effects and every frame on screen - has been guided by a single thought: to honour this extraordinary legacy with the dignity and respect it deserves while presenting it through the finest cinematic craftsmanship possible.”

At a recent event, Malhotra said over 10,000 people have contributed to the making of the film from different parts of the world.

PTI